

PARIKSHA365 — STUDY NOTES

General Knowledge — Common Book

All exams — Awards, Sports, Days, People, Books,
Culture

SSC

RRB

BANKS

STATE PSC

PSU

v 2026-04

The promise. Read this book end-to-end (with the usual two re-reads + active recall on the embedded prompts) and you will be able to attempt every quiz question in the Pariksha365 pool for this subject with a strong fundamental grasp.

EXAMINER BLUEPRINT — What Gets Tested Most

General Knowledge is the section where well-prepared students lose marks to poorly-prepared ones who happened to remember the right niche fact.

This book is built to close that gap.

EXAM ALERT

Top 8 GK exam hotspots

1. **National symbols** — national animal, bird, flower, tree, sport, anthem, song, calendar, currency, emblem, fruit. Appears in every exam, every year — guaranteed marks.
2. **Important days and dates** — World Environment Day (5 June), World AIDS Day (1 Dec), Gandhi Jayanti (2 Oct), Republic Day (26 Jan). 2–3 questions every exam.
3. **Awards** — Bharat Ratna, Padma Vibhushan, Nobel Prize (most recent years), Sahitya Akademi, Khel Ratna. Each award's latest recipients + all-time firsts.
4. **Classical dances** — all 8 classical forms with their states. These appear in every State PSC, SSC CGL, and UPSC Prelims.
5. **Folk dances by state** — Garba (Gujarat), Bihu (Assam), Ghoomar (Rajasthan), Lavani (Maharashtra). Examiners especially love Northeast and tribal dances.
6. **First in India/world** — first woman PM, first woman President, first Indian in space, first Nobel laureate from India. Classic one-mark questions.
7. **International organisations** — UN organs (6), World Bank, IMF, WTO headquarters and founding years, current heads. Matching questions are very common.
8. **Sports** — Olympic milestones, Asian Games rankings, stadium-by-city, national sports of key countries.

KEY FACT

Study priority for time-poor students

1. National symbols table (15 items = easy guaranteed marks)
2. Classical dance forms — all 8 with states
3. Important days — 20 most-asked
4. Awards — Bharat Ratna all-time list + most recent Padmas
5. First in India — 15 key firsts
6. International organisations — HQs + heads
7. Folk dances — 10 most-asked states, especially Northeast
8. Sports firsts and records

What's New This Year (General Knowledge)

*Awards, sports records, current officeholders, international rankings change every year. Re-check before any exam later than Q3 2026. The rest of this book (national symbols, important days, books-and-authors classics, UN principal organs structure, agency HQs, classical-dance facts) is **static and stable**.*

Item	Current value (verify before your exam)
Bharat Ratna — total count	53 (latest batch 2024: Karpoori Thakur, M.S. Swaminathan, L.K. Advani, Chaudhary Charan Singh, P.V. Narasimha Rao)
Padma Awards 2026	131 total: 5 Padma Vibhushan + 13 Padma Bhushan + 113 Padma Shri (announced 25 Jan 2026)
Khel Ratna 2024	Manu Bhaker (shooting), D Gukesh (chess), Harmanpreet Singh (hockey), Praveen Kumar (para high jump)
Nobel Prize 2025	Physics: Clarke+Devoret+Martinis · Chemistry: Kitagawa+Robson+Yaghi · Medicine: Brunkow+Ramsdell+Sakaguchi · Literature: László Krasznahorkai · Peace: María Corina Machado · Economics: Mokyr+Aghion+Howitt
Booker Prize 2025	David Szalay — <i>Flesh</i> (10 Nov 2025) · International Booker: Banu Mushtaq + Deepa Bhasthi — <i>Heart Lamp</i>
UN Secretary - General	António Guterres (term ends 31 Dec 2026)
World Bank President	Ajay Banga (14th, since 2 Jun 2023)
IMF Managing Director	Kristalina Georgieva (2nd term from 1 Oct 2024)
WTO Director - General	Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala
NATO members	32 (Sweden joined as 32nd, 7 Mar 2024)
BRICS members	11 full members (Indonesia joined Jan 2025) + 10 partner countries
Maharatna CPSEs	14 (HAL added 12 Oct 2024 as 14th Maharatna)
Pamban Bridge	New Pamban Bridge inaugurated 6 Apr 2025; India's 1st vertical-lift railway sea bridge; 2.07 km, Tamil Nadu
Paris Olympics 2024 — India	6 medals (1 Silver, 5 Bronze), 71st rank
Tiger reserves	58 (57th = Ratapani MP, Dec 2024; 58th = Madhav MP, Mar 2025)
US President	Donald Trump (47th, 2nd term since 20 Jan 2025)

Item	Current value (verify before your exam)
Census 2027	Phase I launched 1 Apr 2026; first fully digital census; includes caste enumeration

How to use this book

GK is a graveyard of rote learning for most aspirants.

- They try to memorise unconnected facts.
- Then forget them under exam pressure.

This book beats that by:

- **Grouping facts by category** — awards, dances, sports, international organisations.
- **Anchoring each cluster** to a story or a memorable hook.

Where marks are most often lost

- Folk dances of **Northeast India**.
- **Tribal art forms** and martial arts of specific states.
- **Musical instruments**.

These are the questions most candidates skip because they seem obscure.

Result: 1–2 marks every paper go to whoever bothered to read this section.

How to study GK

- Work **one section at a time**.
- Read a table, close the book, **produce it from memory**.
- If you can't name 7 of 8 items → re-read and try again.
- **Spaced repetition** (today, +3 days, +7 days) gives the best results.

The "What's New" section

- Changes every year — **re-read one week before any exam**.
- Everything else in this book (national symbols, classical dances, Bhakti saints, important days, historical firsts) is **static and does not change**.

How to read this book — your real study load

Total pages: 77. Don't let the page count scare you.

Mandatory reading — pages 1 to 35 (45% of the book)

That's the full syllabus. Master those 35 pages and you've covered every concept an examiner can fairly ask.

Bonus material — pages 36 to 77 (55% of the book)

Reference tables, compilations, and self-test material — useful in your last week of revision OR if you're aiming for a top rank.

Two study tracks

- **Just want to pass?** Read pages 1–35. Skim the appendices once before the exam.
 - **Want to top your batch?** Read the appendices too — they're how 70% becomes 90%.
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Pages	Part / Chapter	Topic / What it covers
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p55–60	PART AB	IMPORTANT DAYS — COMPLETE CALENDAR — <i>Important Days — complete year calendar.</i>
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p72–77	PART AF	FAMOUS "FIRSTS" IN INDIA — <i>Famous 'Firsts' in India.</i>

PART A — INDIAN CULTURE & HERITAGE

Chapter A1 — Classical Dances of India

Eight recognised classical dances (Sangeet Natak Akademi):

Dance	State	Key feature	Legendary exponent
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu	Oldest; temple origin; fire dance	Rukmini Devi Arundale, Yamini Krishnamurthy
Kathak	North India (UP)	Footwork, fast spins; Hindu + Mughal fusion	Birju Maharaj, Sitara Devi
Kathakali	Kerala	Elaborate masks; male-dominated	Kalamandalam Gopi
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh	Brass-plate dance; Siddhendra Yogi	Vempati Chinna Satyam
Odissi	Odisha	Tribhangi posture; Jagannath temple	Kelucharan Mohapatra, Sonal Mansingh
Manipuri	Manipur	Lai Haraoba; Ras Leela	Guru Bipin Singh
Mohiniyattam	Kerala	Solo female; slow, graceful	Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma
Sattriya	Assam	Vaishnavite monasteries; Sankardeva	—

Mnemonic: **"Bengal Kittens Kick Kidneys Of Mighty Monks, Sarge"** → B(haratanatyam), K(athak), K(athakali), K(uchipudi), O(dissi), M(anipuri), M(ohiniyattam), S(attriya).

Chapter A2 — Folk Dances (exam favourites)

These are gold-dust for examiners. Know at least two per major state.

State	Famous folk dances
Punjab	Bhangra (male), Giddha (female)
Haryana	Dhamal, Saang
Rajasthan	Ghoomar, Kalbelia, Teratali, Chari
Gujarat	Garba, Dandiya Raas, Tippani
Maharashtra	Lavani, Koli, Dhangari Gaja, Powada
Goa	Dekhnni, Fugdi
Karnataka	Yakshagana, Dollu Kunita
Kerala	Thiruvathira, Theyyam, Padayani, Ottamthullal
Tamil Nadu	Karagattam, Kummi, Kolattam, Mayil attam
Andhra Pradesh	Kuchipudi (classical), Burrakatha, Perini
Telangana	Perini Sivatandavam, Bonalu
Odisha	Chhau (also Jharkhand + WB), Ghumura, Gotipua
West Bengal	Chhau (Purulia), Gambhira, Kirtan
Bihar	Jat-Jatin, Chhau, Jhumar
Jharkhand	Jhumar, Paika, Chhau
Chhattisgarh	Panthi, Raut Nacha, Saila
Madhya Pradesh	Matki, Tertali, Gangaur
Uttar Pradesh	Kathak (classical), Rasleela, Charkula
Uttarakhand	Chholiya, Jhora, Chhapeli
Himachal	Kinnauri, Namagen, Nati
Jammu & Kashmir	Rouf, Hikar, Dumhal, Kud
Ladakh	Jabro, Chabs-skyan
Assam	Bihu (the famous one), Jhumur
Meghalaya	Wangala (Garo), Shad Suk Mynsiem (Khasi)

State	Famous folk dances
Arunachal Pradesh	Aji Lamu, Chalo, Wancho
Nagaland	Chang Lo, Zeliang, Temangnetin
Manipur	Thang Ta, Lai Haraoba, Maibi
Mizoram	Cheraw (bamboo dance), Khuallam
Tripura	Hojagiri, Garia, Lebang Boomani
Sikkim	Chu Faat, Singhi Chham (snow lion)

Memory aid: "India Tour Bus"

Start at the bus stand in Punjab (Bhangra music). Move east: Haryana (Dhamal) → Rajasthan (dust storms + Ghoomar) → Gujarat (Garba nights) → Maharashtra (Lavani stage) → Goa (beach Fugdi) → down to Karnataka/Kerala (Yakshagana fire + Theyyam) → TN (Karagattam pot) → up East coast (AP/Telangana/Odisha) → West Bengal/Bihar/Jharkhand (Chhau masks) → Chhattisgarh (Panthi) → MP → UP (Charkula with pots on head) → Himalayas (Nati) → J&K (Rouf) → Ladakh → NE sweep (Bihu → Hojagiri).

Exam pointers

- "Bamboo dance?" → **Cheraw (Mizoram)**.
- "Snow lion dance?" → **Singhi Chham (Sikkim)**.
- "Tiger dance?" → **Pulikali (Kerala, Onam)**.
- "Dance with brass pot on head?" → **Ghoomar/Bhavai (Rajasthan) / Karagattam (TN)**.
- "Classical in Assam?" → **Sattriya**.

Chapter A3 — Music: Hindustani vs Carnatic

Feature	Hindustani	Carnatic
Region	North India	South India
Influences	Persian + Hindu	Purely Hindu (Vedic)
Structure	Gharana - driven, freer	Composition - driven, stricter
Instruments	Sitar, sarod, tabla, sarangi, santoor	Veena, mridangam, ghatam, violin
Vocal forms	Dhrupad, Khayal, Thumri, Tappa	Kriti, Varnam, Tillana
Saints	Tansen, Amir Khusrau	Purandara Dasa (father of Carnatic), Tyagaraja, Muthuswami Dikshitar, Syama Sastri (Trinity)

Schools/Gharanas (Hindustani)

Agra, Gwalior (oldest khyal), Kirana, Patiala, Jaipur-Atrauli, Banaras, Mewati, Bhendi Bazaar.

Exam pointers

- "Trinity of Carnatic music?" → **Tyagaraja, Muthuswami Dikshitar, Syama Sastri.**
- "Father of Carnatic music?" → **Purandara Dasa.**
- "Sitar-tabla combo originator?" → **Amir Khusrau (attributed).**

Chapter A4 — Paintings (exam favourite)

Style	State/Origin	Distinctive features
Madhubani / Mithila	Bihar	Fish, peacocks, deities; natural dyes
Warli	Maharashtra (tribal)	White stick figures on mud wall
Pattachitra	Odisha & WB	Cloth/palm-leaf; Jagannath themes
Phad	Rajasthan	Scrolls narrating folk hero tales (Pabuji)
Pichwai	Rajasthan (Nathdwara)	Krishna, cows, lotus
Tanjore	Tamil Nadu	Gold foil, gemstones, Hindu deities
Kalighat	West Bengal	Colonial Bengal satire
Kangra / Pahari	HP	Miniatures, soft colours, romantic
Mughal miniature	North India	Court scenes, fine brushwork
Rajput	Rajasthan	Heroism, Krishna, music
Kalamkari	Andhra Pradesh	Hand/block on cotton; Hindu epics
Gond	Madhya Pradesh	Dots & lines; natural motifs
Cheriyal scroll	Telangana	Long scroll; Nakashi families
Saura	Odisha	Tribal; fishermen, rituals
Mysore	Karnataka	Gesso + gold foil; Hindu gods
Thangka	Ladakh/Sikkim/Tibetan	Buddhist scroll painting

Chapter A5 — Handicrafts / Weaving / GI tags

Craft	Region
Pashmina shawl	Kashmir
Kani shawl	Kashmir
Phulkari	Punjab
Chikankari	Lucknow (UP)
Zardozi	Lucknow, Hyderabad
Banarasi silk	Varanasi
Kanjivaram silk	Tamil Nadu
Pochampally ikat	Telangana
Patola	Gujarat

Craft	Region
Bandhani (tie - dye)	Gujarat, Rajasthan
Bagh / Bagru / Sanganeri prints	MP / Rajasthan
Kalamkari	AP
Channapatna toys	Karnataka
Etikoppaka toys	AP
Bidriware	Karnataka (Bidar)
Pembarthi metal craft	Telangana
Dhokra	Chhattisgarh, WB, Odisha

Exam pointers

- "Warli originates from?" → **Maharashtra (tribal).**
- "Madhubani?" → **Bihar.**
- "Pattachitra?" → **Odisha (and WB).**
- "Dhokra = ?" → **Lost-wax metal casting; Chhattisgarh/Jharkhand/WB.**

Chapter A6 — Martial Arts

Art	State
Kalaripayattu	Kerala (world's oldest?)
Silambam	Tamil Nadu (bamboo staff)
Thang - Ta / Huyen Langlon	Manipur
Gatka	Punjab (Sikh)
Lathi	Punjab, Bengal
Mardani Khel	Maharashtra
Pari - Khanda	Bihar
Cheibi Gad - ga	Manipur
Kuttu Varisai	TN (unarmed)

Exam pointers

- "Oldest martial art in world?" → **Kalaripayattu (Kerala)**.
- "Manipur sword-spear art?" → **Thang-Ta**.

Chapter A7 — Festivals (state-linked)

Festival	State/Region
Pongal	Tamil Nadu
Onam	Kerala
Ugadi	AP/Telangana/Karnataka
Vishu	Kerala
Bihu (3 types)	Assam
Pohela Boishakh	Bengal
Baisakhi	Punjab
Lohri	Punjab
Pola	Maharashtra (bull)
Gudi Padwa	Maharashtra
Chhath	Bihar/UP/Jharkhand
Hornbill	Nagaland
Losar	Ladakh/Sikkim/Tibetan
Hemis	Ladakh
Saga Dawa	Sikkim
Bathukamma	Telangana
Makar Sankranti / Magh Bihu	Pan-India (Jan 14)
Kumbh Mela	Prayagraj, Haridwar, Nashik, Ujjain (4 sites)
Rann Utsav	Gujarat
Teej	Rajasthan/Haryana/UP
Wangala	Meghalaya (Garo)
Shad Suk Mynsiem	Meghalaya (Khasi)
Solung	Arunachal (Adi)
Nyokum	Arunachal (Nyishi)
Chapchar Kut	Mizoram
Ziro Music Fest	Arunachal
Sangai	Manipur

Exam pointers

- "Hornbill festival?" → **Nagaland, Dec.**
- "Rann Utsav?" → **Kutch, Gujarat.**
- "Sangai Festival?" → **Manipur (brow-antlered deer theme).**

Chapter A8 — Tribes (by state/cluster)

State	Major tribes
Andhra / Telangana	Gond, Chenchu, Koya, Savara
Odisha	Santhal, Bonda, Juang, Koya, Saora
Jharkhand	Santhal, Munda, Oraon, Ho, Bhumij, Birhor
Chhattisgarh	Gond, Halba, Maria, Muria, Baiga
MP	Bhil, Gond, Baiga, Sahariya, Bharia
Maharashtra	Warli, Gond, Bhil, Katkari
Rajasthan	Bhil, Meena, Garasia, Sahariya
Gujarat	Bhil, Dhodia, Siddi
Kerala	Kurumba, Paniya, Kurichiya, Irula, Kadar
TN	Toda, Kota, Irula, Kurumba, Badaga
Karnataka	Soliga, Yerava, Koraga, Gowdalu
Arunachal	Nyishi, Adi, Apatani, Mishmi, Monpa, Galo
Nagaland	Naga tribes (Ao, Angami, Sema, Konyak, etc.)
Meghalaya	Khasi, Jaintia, Garo
Manipur	Meitei (majority), Nagas, Kukis
Mizoram	Mizo, Lushai
Tripura	Tripuri, Reang, Chakma
Assam	Bodo, Mishing, Karbi, Rabha, Tiwa
Sikkim	Lepcha, Bhutia, Nepali
Uttarakhand	Jaunsari, Bhotia, Tharu, Raji, Buksa
HP	Gaddi, Gujjar, Pangwala, Lahaula, Kinnauri
J&K / Ladakh	Gujjar-Bakarwal, Balti, Brokpa, Changpa
Andaman & Nicobar	Jarawa, Onge, Sentinelese, Shompen, Great Andamanese, Nicobarese

Exam pointers

- "Sentinelese are in?" → **North Sentinel Island (A&N); voluntarily isolated.**
- "Apatani known for?" → **Ziro valley; wet-rice+fish culture, facial markings (historic).**
- "Toda tribe found in?" → **Nilgiris, TN.**
- "PVTGs count?" → **75 (Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups).**

PART B — AWARDS AND HONOURS

Chapter B1 — Indian Civilian Awards (hierarchy)

1. **Bharat Ratna** (since 1954) — highest civilian; max 3/year.
 2. **Padma Vibhushan** — exceptional & distinguished service.
 3. **Padma Bhushan** — distinguished service of high order.
 4. **Padma Shri** — distinguished service.
- 1st Bharat Ratna: **C. Rajagopalachari, S. Radhakrishnan, C.V. Raman (1954)**.
 - 1st posthumous: **Lal Bahadur Shastri (1966)**.
 - Youngest: **Sachin Tendulkar (40, 2014)**.
 - Non-Indian recipients: **Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan (1987)** and **Nelson Mandela (1990)**.
 - Naturalised: **Mother Teresa (1980)**.
 - **2024 recipients:** Karpoori Thakur, L.K. Advani, P.V. Narasimha Rao, Chaudhary Charan Singh, M.S. Swaminathan.

Chapter B2 — Gallantry Awards (peacetime)

- **Param Vir Chakra** (wartime, highest military — 21 awardees; first Major Somnath Sharma, 1947).
- **Maha Vir Chakra** (wartime, 2nd).
- **Vir Chakra** (wartime, 3rd).
- **Ashoka Chakra** (peacetime, highest).
- **Kirti Chakra** (peacetime, 2nd).
- **Shaurya Chakra** (peacetime, 3rd).

Chapter B3 — Sports Awards

- **Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna** (highest; earlier Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna; renamed 2021).
- **Arjuna Award** — outstanding performance over 4 years.
- **Dronacharya Award** — coaches.
- **Dhyan Chand Award** — lifetime (athletes).
- **Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar** — promoting sports.

Chapter B4 — Literature & Cinema

- **Jnanpith Award** — highest literary (since 1965). 22 recognised Indian languages.
- 1st recipient: **G. Sankara Kurup (Malayalam, 1965)**.
- 1st woman: **Ashapurna Devi (Bengali, 1976)**.
- **Sahitya Akademi** — works in 24 languages.
- **Dadasaheb Phalke Award** — cinema lifetime. 1st: **Devika Rani (1969)**.
- **National Film Awards** — annual.

Chapter B5 — International

- **Nobel Prizes to Indians/Indian-origin:**

- **Rabindranath Tagore** (Literature, 1913).
- **C.V. Raman** (Physics, 1930).
- **Hargobind Khorana** (Medicine, 1968).
- **Mother Teresa** (Peace, 1979).
- **Subrahmanyam Chandrasekhar** (Physics, 1983).
- **Amartya Sen** (Economics, 1998).
- **V. Ramakrishnan** (Chemistry, 2009).
- **Kailash Satyarthi** (Peace, 2014).
- **Abhijit Banerjee** (Economics, 2019).
- **Magsaysay Awards** — "Asian Nobel." 1st Indian: **Vinoba Bhave (1958)**.
- **Bharat Ratna vs Nobel**: the only Indian with both for separate causes = **Mother Teresa (Nobel Peace 1979, Bharat Ratna 1980)**.

Exam pointers

- "Bharat Ratna — max per year?" → **3**.
- "PVC awardees so far?" → **21 (as of Apr 2026)**.
- "Khel Ratna renamed to?" → **Major Dhyan Chand, 2021**.
- "Nobel in Economics Indian?" → **Amartya Sen (1998), Abhijit Banerjee (2019)**.

PART C — SPORTS

Chapter C1 — Olympics

- **First modern Olympics:** Athens, 1896.
- **Olympic rings colours:** Blue, Yellow, Black, Green, Red (on white) — represent 5 continents.
- **Motto:** Citius, Altius, Fortius, Communiter ("Faster, Higher, Stronger, Together" — added 2021).
- **Headquarters:** Lausanne, Switzerland.
- **2024 Paris / 2028 LA / 2032 Brisbane / 2036 ?**
- **Winter Olympics separately since 1924.**

India at Olympics

- **1st Individual Olympic gold:** **Abhinav Bindra** (10m air rifle, Beijing 2008).
- **1st Athletics Olympic gold:** **Neeraj Chopra** (javelin, Tokyo 2020 → held 2021).
- **Hockey golds:** 8 (1928-1980).
- **Paris 2024 haul:** 1 silver (Neeraj Chopra) + 5 bronze; total 6 medals.

Chapter C2 — Cricket (ICC-level)

- **ICC HQ:** Dubai, UAE.
- **World Cup winners:** WI (1975, 1979), India (1983, 2011), Australia (1987, 1999, 2003, 2007, 2015, 2023), Pakistan (1992), Sri Lanka (1996), England (2019).
- **T20 World Cup winners:** India (2007, 2024), Pak (2009), Eng (2010, 2022), WI (2012, 2016), SL (2014), Aus (2021).
- **India's last WC win:** **ODI 2011** (first host nation to win on home soil).
- **T20 2024 win:** Barbados, India beat South Africa.
- **India's 1st Test:** 1932 (Lord's, vs England, lost).
- **India's 1st Test win:** 1952 (vs England, Madras).
- **IPL** started 2008.

Chapter C3 — Key Cups / Trophies by Sport

Sport	Trophy
Football (World)	FIFA World Cup
Football (club Europe)	UEFA Champions League
Football (India)	Durand Cup (oldest Asia, 1888), Santosh Trophy, Federation Cup
Hockey (World)	FIH World Cup
Hockey (India)	Rangaswamy Cup, Beighton Cup, Agha Khan Cup
Cricket (India domestic)	Ranji Trophy, Duleep Trophy, Irani Trophy, Vijay Hazare, Deodhar
Golf	Ryder Cup, Masters, US Open

Sport	Trophy
Tennis Grand Slams	Aus Open, French Open, Wimbledon, US Open
Davis Cup	Men's tennis teams
Thomas Cup	Men's badminton teams
Uber Cup	Women's badminton teams
Sudirman Cup	Mixed badminton teams
Swaythling Cup	Men's TT teams

Exam pointers

- "India's first World Cup (ODI)?" → **1983, Lord's, captain Kapil Dev.**
- "Ryder Cup?" → **Golf (USA vs Europe).**
- "Thomas Cup first Indian win?" → **2022 (Bangkok).**
- "Oldest football cup in Asia?" → **Durand Cup, 1888.**

PART D — BOOKS AND AUTHORS

Chapter D1 — Key historical / modern

Book	Author
Arthashastra	Kautilya/Chanakya
Mudrarakshasa	Vishakhadatta
Mrichhakatika	Shudraka
Indica	Megasthenes
Kural (Tirukkural)	Thiruvalluvar
Silappadikaram	Ilango Adigal
Manimekalai	Sittalai Sattanar
Rajatarangini	Kalhana
Geet Govind	Jayadeva
Prithviraj Raso	Chand Bardai
Ain-i-Akbari, Akbarnama	Abul Fazl
Tuzuk-i-Babri	Babur
Baburnama	Babur
Humayun-nama	Gulbadan Begum
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	Jahangir
Padmavat	Malik Muhammad Jayasi
Gitanjali	Tagore
Discovery of India	Nehru
My Experiments with Truth	Gandhi
India Wins Freedom	Maulana Azad
Poverty & Un-British Rule	Dadabhai Naoroji
Unhappy India	Lala Lajpat Rai
Anandmath	Bankim Chandra
Devdas / Parineeta	Sarat Chandra
Godan, Gaban	Premchand
Malgudi Days, The Guide	R.K. Narayan

Book	Author
Train to Pakistan	Khushwant Singh
God of Small Things	Arundhati Roy
Midnight's Children, Satanic Verses	Salman Rushdie
White Tiger	Aravind Adiga
Inheritance of Loss	Kiran Desai
Sea of Poppies (Ibis trilogy)	Amitav Ghosh
A Suitable Boy	Vikram Seth
Interpreter of Maladies, Namesake	Jhumpa Lahiri
The Hungry Tide	Amitav Ghosh
A Passage to India	E.M. Forster

Exam pointers

- "Arthashastra?" → **Kautilya**.
- "Rajatarangini?" → **Kalhana, history of Kashmir**.
- "Who wrote Baburnama in Turkish?" → **Babur**.
- "Nobel for Gitanjali?" → **Tagore, 1913**.

PART E — IMPORTANT DAYS (chronological)

January

- 1 — Army Day (15), DRDO (1), World Day of Peace (1), Global Family Day
- 9 — Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 — World Hindi Day
- 12 — National Youth Day (Vivekananda)
- 15 — Army Day
- 24 — National Girl Child Day
- 25 — National Voters' Day
- 26 — Republic Day / International Customs Day
- 30 — Martyrs' Day (Gandhi)

February

- 2 — World Wetlands Day
- 4 — World Cancer Day
- 13 — World Radio Day
- 14 — Valentine's Day / V.D. Savarkar Jayanti
- 20 — World Day of Social Justice
- 21 — International Mother Language Day
- 28 — National Science Day (Raman Effect)

March

- 3 — World Wildlife Day
- 8 — International Women's Day
- 15 — World Consumer Rights Day
- 20 — International Day of Happiness
- 21 — World Forestry Day, Int'l Day for Elimination of Racial Discrimination
- 22 — World Water Day
- 23 — Shaheed Diwas (Bhagat Singh)
- 24 — World TB Day
- 27 — World Theatre Day

April

- 2 — World Autism Awareness Day
- 5 — National Maritime Day
- 7 — World Health Day
- 10 — World Homoeopathy Day
- 11 — National Safe Motherhood Day
- 14 — Ambedkar Jayanti

- 18 — World Heritage Day
- 21 — National Civil Services Day
- 22 — Earth Day
- 23 — World Book & Copyright Day
- 24 — National Panchayati Raj Day
- 25 — World Malaria Day

May

- 1 — Int'l Labour Day
- 3 — World Press Freedom Day
- 8 — World Red Cross Day (Dunant birth)
- 11 — National Technology Day (Pokhran-II)
- 12 — Int'l Nurses Day (Nightingale)
- 15 — Int'l Day of Families
- 17 — World Telecom Day
- 18 — Int'l Museum Day
- 22 — Int'l Day for Biological Diversity
- 31 — World No Tobacco Day

June

- 1 — World Milk Day
- 5 — World Environment Day
- 8 — World Oceans Day
- 12 — World Day Against Child Labour
- 14 — World Blood Donor Day
- 20 — World Refugee Day
- 21 — Int'l Yoga Day, Father's Day
- 23 — Int'l Olympic Day
- 26 — Int'l Day Against Drug Abuse

July

- 1 — National Doctors Day (B.C. Roy)
- 11 — World Population Day
- 18 — Nelson Mandela Int'l Day
- 28 — World Hepatitis Day

August

- 6 — Hiroshima Day
- 9 — Nagasaki Day, Quit India Day
- 12 — Int'l Youth Day
- 15 — Independence Day

- 19 — World Humanitarian Day, World Photography Day
- 23 — National Space Day (Chandrayaan-3)
- 29 — National Sports Day (Dhyan Chand)

September

- 5 — Teachers' Day (Radhakrishnan)
- 8 — Int'l Literacy Day
- 14 — Hindi Divas
- 15 — Engineer's Day (Visvesvaraya)
- 16 — World Ozone Day
- 21 — Int'l Day of Peace
- 27 — World Tourism Day
- 29 — World Heart Day

October

- 1 — Int'l Day of Older Persons
- 2 — Gandhi Jayanti / Int'l Day of Non-Violence / Shastri Jayanti
- 5 — World Teachers Day
- 8 — Indian Air Force Day
- 9 — World Post Day
- 10 — World Mental Health Day
- 14 — World Standards Day
- 16 — World Food Day
- 17 — Int'l Day for the Eradication of Poverty
- 24 — United Nations Day
- 31 — Rashtriya Ekta Diwas (Sardar Patel), World Savings Day

November

- 7 — Infant Protection Day, Nat'l Cancer Awareness Day
- 11 — National Education Day (Maulana Azad)
- 14 — Children's Day (Nehru), Diabetes Day
- 19 — Int'l Toilet Day
- 20 — Universal Children's Day
- 21 — World TV Day, World Fisheries Day
- 25 — Int'l Day for Elimination of Violence Against Women
- 26 — Constitution Day / Law Day
- 29 — Int'l Day of Solidarity with Palestinian People

December

- 1 — World AIDS Day
- 2 — Bhopal Gas Tragedy (1984)

- 3 — Int'l Day of Persons with Disabilities
- 4 — Indian Navy Day
- 7 — Armed Forces Flag Day
- 10 — Human Rights Day
- 11 — UNICEF Day
- 14 — National Energy Conservation Day
- 16 — Vijay Diwas (1971 war)
- 22 — National Mathematics Day (Ramanujan)
- 23 — Kisan Diwas (Chaudhary Charan Singh)
- 25 — Good Governance Day (Vajpayee)

Exam pointers

- "National Science Day commemorates?" → **Raman Effect (28 Feb 1928).**
- "Yoga Day?" → **21 June.**
- "Constitution Day?" → **26 November.**
- "National Technology Day?" → **11 May (Pokhran-II).**
- "Space Day?" → **23 August (Chandrayaan-3).**

PART F — INSTITUTIONS & ORGANISATIONS

Chapter F1 — UN Bodies (HQ + focus)

Body	HQ	Focus
UN	New York	Umbrella
UNESCO	Paris	Education, culture, science
UNICEF	New York	Children
WHO	Geneva	Health
ILO	Geneva	Labour
FAO	Rome	Food, agriculture
IMF	Washington DC	Monetary
World Bank	Washington DC	Development
WTO	Geneva	Trade
IAEA	Vienna	Atomic energy
UNEP	Nairobi	Environment
UNDP	New York	Development programme
IMO	London	Maritime
ICAO	Montreal	Aviation
UPU	Bern	Postal
ITU	Geneva	Telecom
WMO	Geneva	Meteorology
WIPO	Geneva	Intellectual Property

Chapter F2 — Non-UN & Regional

Body	HQ	Role
Commonwealth	London	56 members
NATO	Brussels	Military alliance
OPEC	Vienna	Oil cartel (13 members)
ASEAN	Jakarta	SE Asia
SAARC	Kathmandu	South Asia (8)

Body	HQ	Role
BIMSTEC	Dhaka	Bay of Bengal (7)
SCO	Beijing	Shanghai Coop Org (India joined 2017)
BRICS	—	Brazil/Russia/India/China/S.Africa + expanded 2024
G7	rotating	7 industrialised nations
G20	rotating	20 major economies
QUAD	—	US, India, Japan, Australia
AU	Addis Ababa	African Union
EU	Brussels	European Union
OECD	Paris	Developed economies
Interpol	Lyon	Police
ICJ	Hague	Int'l Court of Justice
ICC	Hague	Criminal Court
PCA	Hague	Permanent Court of Arbitration
Int'l Olympic Cmte	Lausanne	Olympics
Red Cross	Geneva	Humanitarian

Exam pointers

- "OPEC HQ?" → **Vienna, Austria.**
- "NATO members?" → **32 (as of 2026, Finland and Sweden joined recently).**
- "G20 2023 host?" → **India (New Delhi Declaration).**
- "SAARC created?" → **1985, Dhaka.**
- "BRICS expanded 2024 — new members?" → **Egypt, UAE, Iran, Ethiopia (Argentina & Saudi Arabia invited; status varies).**

PART G — COUNTRIES AND CAPITALS (select)

World's unusual/boundary capitals

Country	Capital
USA	Washington D.C.
UK	London
Canada	Ottawa
Australia	Canberra
Brazil	Brasilia
Russia	Moscow
China	Beijing
Japan	Tokyo
Nepal	Kathmandu
Bhutan	Thimphu
Sri Lanka	Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte (admin) / Colombo (commercial)
Myanmar	Naypyidaw
Bangladesh	Dhaka
Pakistan	Islamabad
Afghanistan	Kabul
Maldives	Malé
Iran	Tehran
Saudi Arabia	Riyadh
UAE	Abu Dhabi
Israel	Jerusalem (declared) / Tel Aviv (de facto)
Turkey	Ankara
Egypt	Cairo (new admin capital "New Administrative Capital")
South Africa	3 capitals — Pretoria (exec), Cape Town (legislative), Bloemfontein (judicial)
Nigeria	Abuja
Indonesia	Jakarta → Nusantara (planned shift)
Philippines	Manila

Country	Capital
Thailand	Bangkok
Vietnam	Hanoi
Malaysia	Kuala Lumpur (official), Putrajaya (admin)
Singapore	Singapore
Switzerland	Bern
Germany	Berlin
France	Paris
Italy	Rome
Spain	Madrid
Greece	Athens
Portugal	Lisbon
Sweden	Stockholm
Norway	Oslo
Denmark	Copenhagen
Finland	Helsinki
Netherlands	Amsterdam (Hague = govt seat)
Belgium	Brussels
Ireland	Dublin
Iceland	Reykjavik
Mexico	Mexico City
Argentina	Buenos Aires
Chile	Santiago
Peru	Lima
Venezuela	Caracas
Colombia	Bogotá
Kenya	Nairobi
Ethiopia	Addis Ababa
South Sudan	Juba
New Zealand	Wellington

Exam pointers

- "South Africa has how many capitals?" → **3**.
- "Sri Lanka admin capital?" → **Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte**.
- "Myanmar capital?" → **Naypyidaw**.
- "Indonesia's new capital?" → **Nusantara**.

PART H — MISCELLANEOUS NUGGETS

Chapter H1 — "Firsts" (Indian women)

- First woman PM: **Indira Gandhi (1966)**.
- First woman President: **Pratibha Patil (2007)**.
- First woman CM: **Sucheta Kripalani (UP, 1963)**.
- First woman Governor: **Sarojini Naidu (UP, 1947)**.
- First woman Judge (SC): **Fathima Beevi (1989)**.
- First woman CJI: **(still pending as of 2026)**.
- First woman IPS: **Kiran Bedi (1972)**.
- First woman IAS: **Anna Rajam Malhotra (1951)**.
- First woman to climb Everest: **Bachendri Pal (1984)**.
- First woman in space (Indian-origin): **Kalpana Chawla (1997)**.
- First woman in space (of Indian nationality, IAF): **Rakesh Sharma was male; woman-Indian-flag in space is still pending Gaganyaan**.
- First woman to cross English Channel: **Aarti Saha (1959)**.
- First woman Olympic medalist: **Karnam Malleswari (Bronze, 2000)**.
- First woman Individual Olympic Silver: **P.V. Sindhu (2016)**.
- First Indian-origin VP of USA: **Kamala Harris (2021)**.

Chapter H2 — Global firsts (quick)

- First man in space: **Yuri Gagarin (USSR, 1961)**.
- First woman in space: **Valentina Tereshkova (USSR, 1963)**.
- First man on Moon: **Neil Armstrong (Apollo 11, 1969)**.
- First Indian in space: **Rakesh Sharma (Soyuz T-11, 1984)**.
- First Indian-origin woman in space: **Kalpana Chawla (1997)**.
- First Nobel Prize: **1901 (Röntgen, physics)**.
- First university: **Nalanda (5th century CE) / Takshashila (earlier)**.

Chapter H3 — "Biggest / Longest / Highest"

- Highest peak (world): **Everest 8,849 m**.
- Highest peak (India): **Kangchenjunga (3rd in world, 8,586 m) — Sikkim**.
- Highest peak entirely in India: **Nanda Devi (Uttarakhand, 7,816 m)**.
- Longest river (world): **Nile 6,650 km** (debated with Amazon).
- Longest river (India, in India): **Ganga (~2,525 km)**.
- Longest river flowing through India: **Brahmaputra (2,900 km total)**.
- Largest lake (world, freshwater): **Caspian — saline; by freshwater Superior**.
- Largest desert: **Antarctica (cold); Sahara (hot)**.
- Deepest ocean point: **Mariana Trench (Challenger Deep), ~11 km**.

- Tallest statue (world): **Statue of Unity, Gujarat, 182 m (Sardar Patel, 2018).**
- Tallest building (world): **Burj Khalifa, Dubai, 828 m.**
- Longest bridge (India): **Bhupen Hazarika Setu (Dhola-Sadiya, Assam, 9.15 km).**
- Highest rail bridge: **Chenab Rail Bridge, J&K (359 m above river).**
- Largest stadium (cricket, world): **Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad (1.32 lakh).**

Exam pointers

- "Highest peak entirely in India?" → **Nanda Devi.**
- "Tallest statue in world?" → **Statue of Unity (Gujarat).**
- "Highest rail bridge in India?" → **Chenab Bridge.**

APPENDICES

Appendix 1 — Newspapers/Founders (freedom-era)

Paper	Founder	Year
Bengal Gazette	James Augustus Hickey	1780 (first English newspaper)
Samvad Kaumudi	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1821
Mirat-ul-Akhbar	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1822
Indian Mirror	Devendranath Tagore & Manmohan Ghose	1861
Amrita Bazar Patrika	Sisir Kumar Ghosh	1868
The Hindu	G.S. Aiyar & others	1878
Kesari / Maratha	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	1881
Swadeshmitran	G. Subramaniya Aiyar	1882
Yugantar	Barindra Kumar Ghosh	1906
Al-Hilal / Al-Balagh	Abul Kalam Azad	1912 / 1915
Young India	M.K. Gandhi	1919
Navjeevan	Gandhi	1919
Harijan	Gandhi	1932
Independent	Motilal Nehru	1919
Comrade	Mohammad Ali Jauhar	1911
New India	Bipin Chandra Pal	1901
Hindustan Standard	Sachidananda Sinha	—

Appendix 2 — Currencies (select)

Country	Currency
India	Rupee
Pakistan / Nepal / Sri Lanka	Rupee
Bangladesh	Taka
Bhutan	Ngultrum
Myanmar	Kyat
Iran	Rial

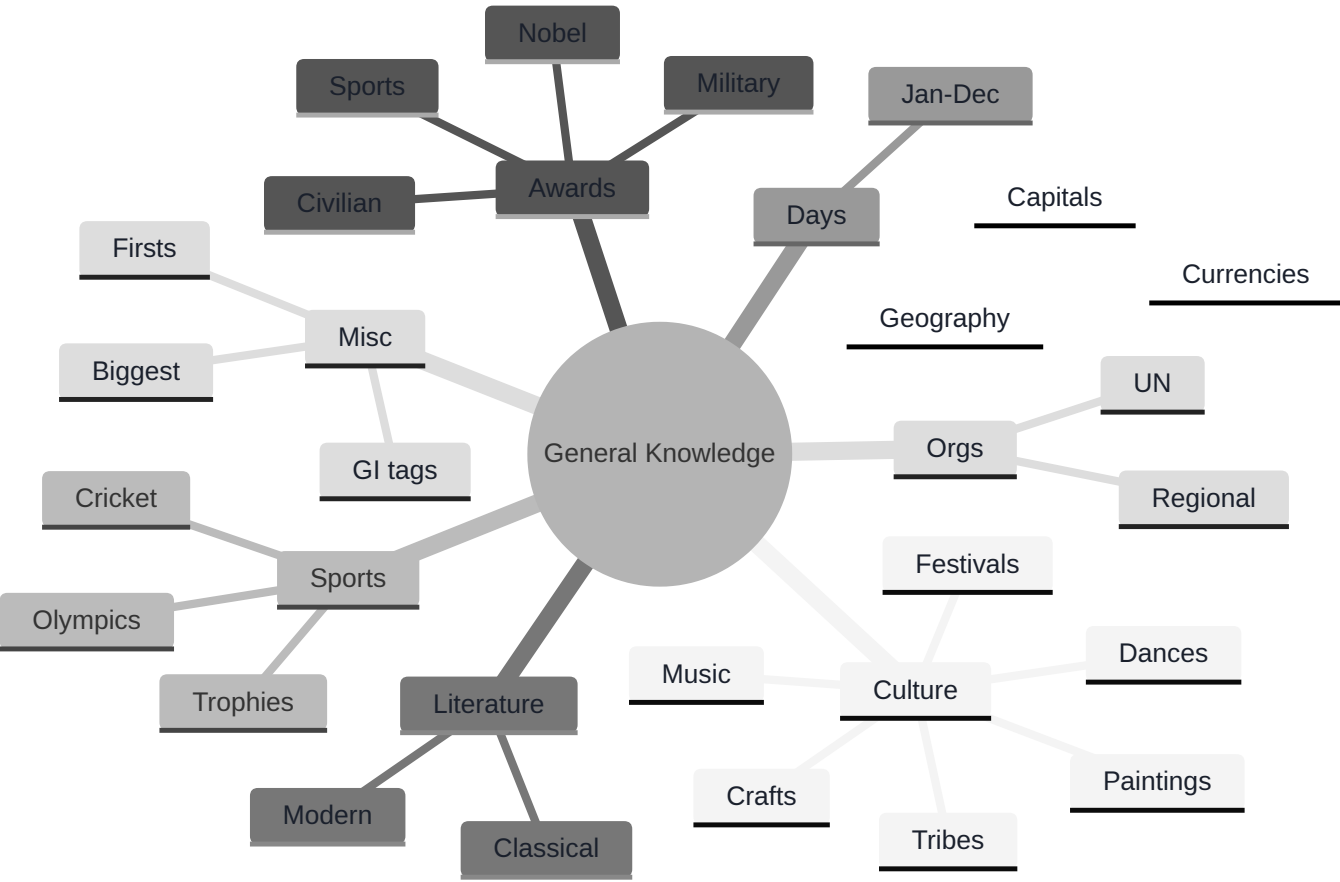
Country	Currency
Iraq	Dinar
Saudi Arabia	Riyal
UAE	Dirham
USA	Dollar
UK	Pound
Japan	Yen
China	Yuan / Renminbi
Russia	Rouble
Germany / France / Italy / Spain + 17 others	Euro (21 Eurozone members as of 1 Jan 2026 — Bulgaria became 21st member; Bulgarian lev rate 1.95583/€)
Switzerland	Franc
South Korea	Won
South Africa	Rand
Israel	Shekel

Appendix 3 — GI-tagged products (recent/exam favourites)

- Banarasi saree — UP.
- Kanjivaram silk — TN.
- Pochampally ikat — Telangana.
- Pashmina — J&K.
- Nagpur orange — Maharashtra.
- Darjeeling tea — WB (India's first GI, 2004).
- Basmati rice — multi-state.
- Tirupati laddu — AP.
- Alphonso mango — Maharashtra.
- Mysore silk — Karnataka.
- Madhubani painting — Bihar.
- Bikaneri bhujia — Rajasthan.
- Channapatna toys — Karnataka.
- Etikoppaka toys — AP.
- Kashmir saffron — J&K.
- Kangra tea — HP.
- Ratlami sev — MP.
- Bhagalpuri silk — Bihar.

- Goan Feni — Goa.
- Nilgiris tea — TN.

Appendix 4 — Mind map



For deeper context on historical events, see the History book. For science and technology details, see the Science & Technology book.

PART X — EXAM-FAVOURITE NICHE TOPICS (paper-setter darlings)

High probability, easy to frame distractors, and most candidates skip them. Drill until you can answer in <5 s.

X.1 Classical Dances — the 8 (origin state, exponent, deity, costume cue)

Dance	State	Notable exponents	Deity / theme	Costume cue
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu	Rukmini Devi Arundale, Balasaraswati, Yamini Krishnamurthy	Shiva (Nataraja)	Pleated silk sari, jewellery, half-fan pleats
Kathak	UP / Jaipur / Lucknow / Banaras gharanas	Birju Maharaj, Sitara Devi, Shovana Narayan	Krishna (Radha - Krishna leelas)	Lehenga-choli or angarkha, ghungroo
Kathakali	Kerala	Kalamandalam Krishnan Nair, Kalamandalam Gopi	Mythology (Mahabharata, Ramayana)	Elaborate face make-up (pacha, kathi), towering headgear
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh	Vempati Chinna Satyam, Raja Reddy & Radha Reddy	Krishna / Vishnu	Sari with fan pleats, tarangam (dancing on plate)
Manipuri	Manipur	Guru Bipin Singh, Jhaveri sisters	Radha-Krishna (Ras Lila)	Cylindrical kumil skirt, veiled face
Odissi	Odisha	Kelucharan Mohapatra, Sonal Mansingh, Madhavi Mudgal	Jagannath (tribhanga posture)	White silk sari, silver jewellery
Mohiniyattam	Kerala	Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma, Sunanda Nair, Bharati Shivaji	Vishnu (Mohini avatar)	White-and-gold sari, lasya-graceful
Sattriya	Assam	Bayanācharya, Manik Borbayan, Jatin Goswami	Krishna (Sankardev's Bhakti)	Pat silk dhoti & dance sari

X.2 Folk Dances — state-wise (must memorise — 1 question per paper minimum)

North:

- **Punjab:** Bhangra (men, harvest), Giddha (women), Jhumar (slow Bhangra), Kikli, Sammi, Luddi.
- **Haryana:** Khoria, Ghoomar (also Rajasthan), Phag, Loor.

- **Himachal Pradesh:** Nati, Chappeli, Dangi, Jhora, Jhainta, Kayang, Bakayang.
- **Uttarakhand:** Garhwali, Pandav Nritya, Chappeli, Choliya (sword), Jhumeila, Hurka Baul.
- **J & K:** Rouf (women, spring), Hikar, Dumhal (Wattal tribe), Bhand Pather, Chakri.
- **Delhi/UP:** Charkula (women on head), Raslila, Khyal, Nautanki, Kajri, Jhulan.

West:

- **Rajasthan:** Ghoomar (Rajputana women), Kalbeliya (snake-charmer community, UNESCO listed), Terah Tali (sitting with manjiras), Bhavai (pots on head), Chari, Gair, Drum dance, Kachchhi Ghodi.
- **Gujarat:** Garba (Navratri), Dandiya Raas (sticks), Bhavai (folk drama), Tippani (Saurashtra women), Padhar (Bhal coast), Hudo (Bhawai).
- **Goa:** Fugdi, Dekhni, Dhalo, Mando, Talgadi, Kunbi (tribal).
- **Maharashtra:** Lavani (sensual Maratha), Tamasha, Koli (fisherfolk), Dhindi, Lezim, Dindi, Powada (heroic ballad).

East / North-East — examiners' favourite zone (under-prepared):

- **Bihar:** Jat-Jatin, Bidesia, Jhijhia, Paika, Sohrai (Sant Pargana), Karma.
- **Jharkhand:** Chhau (also Odisha, WB; UNESCO), Karma, Paika, Jhumar, Phaguwa.
- **West Bengal:** Chhau (Purulia), Gambhira, Dhali, Kathi, Jatra (folk drama), Brita (women's vow dance).
- **Odisha:** Chhau (Mayurbhanj — masked), Ghumura, Ranappa (stilts), Dalkhai (tribal women, Sambalpur), Karma, Dhap, Paika (warrior).
- **Sikkim:** Chu Faat (Lepcha), Singhi Chham (snow lion), Yak Chham, Tashi Yangku, Maruni, Ghantu.
- **Assam:** Bihu (Rongali — spring; Bhogali — Jan; Kongali — autumn), Bagurumba (Bodo women), Ali Ai Ligang (Mising), Deodhani (Shakti goddess), Jhumur (tea-tribe), Sattriya (also classical).
- **Arunachal Pradesh:** Aji Lhamu (Monpa), Lion-Peacock (Sherdukpen), Khampati (Buddhist), Roppi (Adi), Bardo Chham (good-evil battle), Chalo (Nocte).
- **Nagaland:** Hornbill (festival; multiple tribes), Zeliang, Chang Lo (Chang tribe), Modse (Sumi).
- **Manipur:** Lai Haraoba (oldest Manipuri), Thang-Ta (martial), Pung Cholom (drum), Maibi.
- **Mizoram:** Cheraw (bamboo-stick dance), Khuallam, Chheihlam, Sarlamkai, Solakia.
- **Meghalaya:** Nongkrem (Khasi harvest), Wangala (Garo, 100 drums), Shad Suk Mynsiem (Khasi thanksgiving), Behdienkhlam (Jaintia).
- **Tripura:** Hojagiri (Reang women on pitchers), Garia, Lebang Boomani, Bizu (Chakma).

South:

- **Tamil Nadu:** Kummi, Kolattam, Karagam (pot on head), Mayil Attam (peacock), Bommalattam (puppet), Theru Koothu (street drama), Oyilattam, Devarattam.
- **Karnataka:** Yakshagana (theatre-dance), Dollu Kunitha (drum), Veeragase (Shaivite), Krishna Parijatha, Bhutha Aradhane, Kamsale.
- **Andhra Pradesh / Telangana:** Kuchipudi (classical), Burra Katha (storytelling), Veedhi Bhagavatam, Lambadi (Banjara), Perini (warrior), Dhimsa (Araku tribal).
- **Kerala:** Mohiniyattam, Kathakali (classical), Theyyam (ritual god-dance, North Kerala), Padayani (Pathanamthitta), Thiruvathirakali (women's circle), Kaikottikali, Chakyar Koothu (Sanskrit theatre).

Central:

- **Madhya Pradesh / Chhattisgarh:** Karma (tribal), Panthi (Chhattisgarh, Satnami sect), Raut Nacha (Yadav), Saila (post-harvest), Maanch, Tertali, Phaag, Diwari.

Memory peg: "Hornbill = Nagaland; Hojagiri = Tripura on pitchers; Cheraw = Mizoram bamboo; Bihu × 3 = Assam; Garba/Dandiya = Gujarat; Bhangra/Giddha = Punjab; Lavani = Maharashtra; Ghoomar/Kalbeliya = Rajasthan; Chhau = Odisha + Jharkhand + WB."

X.3 State festivals — exam-favourite list

Festival	State	Significance
Pongal	Tamil Nadu (Jan 14 - 17)	Harvest; 4 days — Bhogi, Surya Pongal, Mattu Pongal, Kaanum Pongal
Onam	Kerala (Aug - Sep, Chingam)	Welcome of King Mahabali; pookalam (flower carpets), Vallam Kali (boat race)
Bihu	Assam (3x year)	Rongali / Bohag (spring), Bhogali / Magh (winter harvest), Kongali / Kati (autumn lean)
Chhath	Bihar / Eastern UP (Oct - Nov)	Worship of Sun God + Chhathi Maiya; 4 days
Saga Dawa	Sikkim (May - Jun)	Buddhist — Buddha's birth, enlightenment, parinirvana
Hornbill Festival	Nagaland (Dec 1 - 10)	"Festival of festivals", all Naga tribes; Kohima
Chapchar Kut	Mizoram (Mar)	Spring festival of Mizos, post jhum
Wangala	Meghalaya (Oct - Nov)	Garo tribe, "100 drums festival", harvest thanksgiving
Nongkrem	Meghalaya (Nov)	Khasi 5-day religious dance festival
Behdienkhlam	Meghalaya (Jul)	Pnar / Jaintia, drives away plague & evil
Losar	Sikkim, Arunachal, Ladakh, HP (Jan - Feb)	Tibetan New Year
Lai Haraoba	Manipur (Apr - May)	Oldest Meitei festival, "Pleasing of gods"
Yaoshang	Manipur (Feb - Mar)	Holi-equivalent, 5 days
Bizu	Tripura (Apr)	Chakma New Year
Garia	Tripura (Apr - May)	Tribal, jhum-cultivation
Hemis	Ladakh (Jun - Jul)	Tibetan - Buddhist mask dance, Padmasambhava
Sindhu Darshan	Ladakh (Jun)	Indus river worship, Leh
Pang Lhabsol	Sikkim (Aug - Sep)	Worship of Mt. Kanchenjunga
Ambubachi Mela	Assam (Jun)	Kamakhya temple, menstruation of goddess

Festival	State	Significance
Mahamastakabhisheka	Karnataka (every 12 years)	Anointing of Bahubali at Shravanabelagola
Hampi Utsav	Karnataka (Nov)	Vijayanagar heritage
Mysuru Dasara	Karnataka (Sep-Oct)	10-day royal celebration, Chamundi-procession
Pushkar Mela	Rajasthan (Oct-Nov)	World's largest camel fair
Rann Utsav	Gujarat (Nov-Feb)	White desert of Kutch
Modhera Dance Festival	Gujarat (Jan, Uttarardha Mahotsav)	At Sun Temple
Khajuraho Dance Festival	MP (Feb-Mar)	Classical dance week
Goa Carnival	Goa (Feb-Mar)	Pre-Lent festival
Konark Dance Festival	Odisha (Dec)	Sun Temple backdrop
Hampi Utsav	Karnataka (Nov)	Vijayanagar heritage
Bastar Dussehra	Chhattisgarh (75 days!)	Longest Dussehra; Maa Danteshwari worship
Madai	Chhattisgarh (Dec-Mar)	Tribal — Gond, Halba, Maria, Muria
Theyyam	Kerala (Oct-May)	Ritual god-dance worship in north Kerala
Vishu	Kerala (Apr 14)	Malayali New Year, vishukkani arrangement
Ugadi	Karnataka, Andhra, Telangana (Mar-Apr)	Telugu/Kannada New Year
Gudi Padwa	Maharashtra (Mar-Apr)	Marathi New Year
Baisakhi	Punjab (Apr 13-14)	Sikh New Year + harvest; Khalsa founding (1699)
Karva Chauth	North India (Oct-Nov)	Married-women fast for husbands' longevity
Teej	Rajasthan, Haryana, Punjab (Aug)	Hariyali, Kajli, Hartalika; women's monsoon
Onam, Pongal, Bihu	(covered above)	All harvest festivals — peg the calendar

X.4 Tribes — state focus (under-prepared)

Tribe	State / region	Quick fact
Toda	Nilgiris (TN)	Pastoral, dairy-centric, polyandrous
Bhil	MP, Rajasthan, Gujarat	One of largest tribes; Pithora paintings

Tribe	State / region	Quick fact
Gond	MP, Chhattisgarh, Maharashtra	Largest tribe in India by population
Munda	Jharkhand, WB	Birsa Munda (freedom fighter)
Santhal	Jharkhand, WB, Odisha	Santhali (8th Schedule lang); Santhal Rebellion 1855
Khasi	Meghalaya	Matrilineal; living root bridges
Garos	Meghalaya	Matrilineal; Wangala festival
Jaintia	Meghalaya	Pnar people; Behdienkhlam
Naga	Nagaland (16 major tribes)	Angami, Ao, Sumi, Lotha, Konyak, Chang, Sangtam, Phom, Pochury, Yimchunger, Khamniungan, Rengma, Zeliang, Chakhesang, Kuki
Mizo	Mizoram	Lushai; Cheraw dance
Chakma	Tripura, Mizoram	Buddhist, distinct from rest of NE Hindu / Christian tribes
Bodo	Assam	Largest plains tribe of Assam; Bodoland (BTR)
Apatani	Arunachal	Ziro Valley; UNESCO recognised paddy - fish farming
Nyishi	Arunachal	Largest Arunachal tribe
Adi, Galo, Tagin, Mishmi	Arunachal	Various sub-tribes
Lepcha	Sikkim, Darjeeling	Original Sikkim inhabitants; Bhutia + Lepcha + Nepali = main groups
Bhutia	Sikkim, Ladakh	Tibetan origin
Reang (Bru)	Tripura, Mizoram	Hojagiri dancers
Tripuri	Tripura	Largest Tripura tribe
Banjara (Lambadi)	Telangana, AP, Karnataka	Nomadic; lambadi dance + textile
Yanadi	Andhra Pradesh	Hunter - gatherer - fisher
Irular	Tamil Nadu	Snake - catching expertise
Kani	Tamil Nadu, Kerala	Western Ghats forest dwellers
Bonda	Odisha	Highly endangered (PVTG); shaved - heads with bead necklaces
Juang	Odisha	One of 13 PVTGs of Odisha
Saora	Odisha, AP	Saora paintings

Tribe	State / region	Quick fact
Gaddi	HP	Pastoral semi - nomads, Dhauladhar
Bhotia	Uttarakhand, Sikkim	Trans - Himalayan
Tharu	Uttarakhand, UP, Bihar	Terai region; matrilineal traits
Onge, Jarawa, Sentinelese, Shompen	Andaman & Nicobar	All PVTGs; Sentinelese isolated
Great Andamanese	Andaman	Critically endangered
Siddi	Karnataka, Gujarat	African origin
Warli	Maharashtra	Warli paintings

X.5 Indian paintings — schools & key painters

School	Period	Subject	Key painters
Bagh / Ajanta murals	Ancient (Mauryan - Gupta)	Buddhist — Bodhisattvas	Anonymous monks
Ellora	Rashtrakuta	Jain + Hindu	—
Pala school	9 - 12c (Bengal - Bihar)	Buddhist palm - leaf manuscripts	—
Apabhransha / Jain	W. India (Gujarat, Rajasthan)	Jain manuscripts; angular noses	—
Mughal school	16 - 18c	Court life, portraits, naturalism	Daswanth, Basawan, Mansur (animals), Abul Hasan, Bichitr
Rajasthani / Rajput	16 - 19c	Krishna leela, Ragamala, Bhakti	sub - schools: Mewar, Bundi, Kishangarh (Bani Thani by Nihal Chand), Marwar, Jaipur
Pahari school	17 - 19c	Krishna, mountains	Basohli (bold colours), Guler, Kangra (subtle, lyrical), Chamba
Deccan school	16 - 19c	Persian + Indian fusion	Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar
Madhubani / Mithila	Bihar (folk)	Wedding, mythology, geometric	Sita Devi, Ganga Devi, Bharti Dayal
Warli	Maharashtra (folk)	Stick - figures, daily life	—
Pattachitra	Odisha + Bengal	Cloth - scroll, Jagannath	Akshaya Bariki, Jagannath Mahapatra

School	Period	Subject	Key painters
Kalamkari	Andhra (Srikalahasti) + TN (Machilipatnam)	Hand-painted/printed cloth	—
Tanjore (Thanjavur)	TN (16-17c)	Hindu deities + gold leaf	—
Mysore school	Karnataka	Hindu deities, gesso work	—
Phad	Rajasthan (Bhilwara)	Long cloth scrolls of Pabuji, Devnarayan	Joshi family
Gond	MP (tribal)	Trees, animals, dots-lines	Jangarh Singh Shyam, Bhajju Shyam
Saora	Odisha - AP	Tribal wall paintings (icon)	—
Bhil / Pithora	MP-Gujarat	Wall paintings, dots	—
Bengal school	early 20c	Indian nationalist style	Abanindranath Tagore, Nandalal Bose, Jamini Roy
Modern Indian (Progressive Artists Group, 1947)	post-Independence	Western + Indian	Raja Ravi Varma (predecessor), F.N. Souza, M.F. Husain, S.H. Raza, Tyeb Mehta, Akbar Padamsee, Ram Kumar

X.6 Indian martial arts

Martial art	State	Notes
Kalaripayattu	Kerala	Oldest; "mother of all martial arts" claim
Silambam	Tamil Nadu	Bamboo-staff fighting; Sangam-era
Gatka	Punjab	Sikh sword-fighting; akharas
Thang-Ta (Huyen Lallong)	Manipur	Sword (thang) + spear (ta)
Sarit Sarak	Manipur	Unarmed Manipuri
Mardani Khel	Maharashtra	Sword + dandpatta + lathi
Pari-Khanda	Bihar	Sword + shield, used in Chhau dance
Lathi	Punjab, Bengal	Stick-fighting
Inbuan	Mizoram	Wrestling
Mukna	Manipur	Folk wrestling
Cheibi Gad-ga	Manipur	Cheibi (stick) + leather shield

Martial art	State	Notes
Kuttu Varisai	Tamil Nadu	Empty-hand combat (animal-based stances)
Adimurai	TN, Kerala	Striking + grappling
Thoda	Himachal Pradesh	Bow-and-arrow, ritual at Baisakhi

X.7 Indian classical music — gharanas + maestros

Hindustani vocal gharanas: Gwalior (oldest), Agra, Kirana (Abdul Karim Khan), Patiala (Bade Ghulam Ali Khan), Jaipur-Atrauli (Alladiya Khan), Bhendi Bazaar, Mewati (Pandit Jasraj), Sham Chaurasi, Rampur-Sahaswan.

Carnatic Trinity (18th c., Tiruvarur): Tyagaraja, Muthuswami Dikshitar, Syama Sastri.

Instrument → notable exponents:

Instrument	Maestros
Sitar	Ravi Shankar, Vilayat Khan, Nikhil Banerjee, Anoushka Shankar
Sarod	Ali Akbar Khan, Amjad Ali Khan, Aashish Khan
Sarangi	Sultan Khan, Ram Narayan
Santoor	Shivkumar Sharma, Bhajan Sopori
Flute (Bansuri)	Hariprasad Chaurasia, Pannalal Ghosh
Shehnai	Bismillah Khan
Tabla	Zakir Hussain, Allarakha, Anindo Chatterjee, Kishan Maharaj
Pakhawaj	Pt. Kudau Singh, Bhawani Shankar
Mridangam	Palghat Mani Iyer, Umayalpuram Sivaraman
Veena	S. Balachander, Chitti Babu
Violin (Carnatic)	L. Subramaniam, M.S. Gopalakrishnan, Lalgudi Jayaraman
Nadaswaram	T.N. Rajarathinam Pillai
Ghatam	Vikku Vinayakram
Kanjira	G. Harishankar
Mohan Veena	Vishwa Mohan Bhatt
Rudra Veena	Asad Ali Khan

Vocal Hindustani maestros: Bhimsen Joshi, Kishori Amonkar, Kumar Gandharva, Mallikarjun Mansur, Rashid Khan, Hariharan, Jagjit Singh (ghazal), Ghulam Ali (ghazal-Pakistan).

Carnatic vocal maestros: M.S. Subbulakshmi, Semmangudi Srinivasa Iyer, MD Ramanathan, Yesudas, T.M. Krishna, Sudha Raghunathan, Aruna Sairam.

X.8 Handicrafts + GI tags (state-wise)

Craft / product	State / region	Note
Pashmina shawls	J&K	Cashmere wool
Banarasi silk saree	UP	GI tag
Chikankari embroidery	Lucknow, UP	GI tag
Jaipur blue pottery	Rajasthan	GI tag
Kota Doria	Rajasthan	GI tag
Bidri ware	Karnataka (Bidar)	Black metal + silver inlay
Mysore silk	Karnataka	GI tag
Channapatna toys	Karnataka	GI tag
Pochampally Ikat	Telangana	GI tag
Kanjeevaram silk	Tamil Nadu	GI tag
Tanjore paintings	TN	GI tag
Aranmula Kannadi (mirror)	Kerala	Metal mirror
Coir products	Kerala	GI tag
Madhubani painting	Bihar	GI tag
Bhagalpuri silk (Tussar)	Bihar	GI tag
Sujini (kantha) embroidery	Bihar / Bengal	GI tag
Dhokra metal craft	Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, WB	Lost-wax bronze casting
Phulkari embroidery	Punjab	GI tag
Pashmina + Kani shawl	J&K	GI tag
Sambalpuri saree	Odisha	GI tag
Pattachitra	Odisha + WB	GI tag
Pipili applique	Odisha	GI tag
Naga shawls	Nagaland	GI tag
Nagaland Mekhela	Assam	GI tag
Muga silk	Assam	World's only golden silk
Eri silk	Assam	Vegetarian/Ahimsa silk
Wancho wood - carving	Arunachal	GI tag
Manipur Kachai lemon	Manipur	GI tag (agri)

Craft / product	State / region	Note
Mizoram Mizo Chilli	Mizoram	GI tag
Sikkim Dalle khursani	Sikkim	GI tag
Tripura Pachra - Risa	Tripura	GI tag
Rosogolla	West Bengal (also Odisha contention; both got GIs)	GI
Darjeeling tea	WB	India's first GI (2004)
Nilgiri tea	TN	GI
Coorg orange	Karnataka	GI (agri)
Mahabaleshwar strawberry	Maharashtra	GI
Nashik wine grape	Maharashtra	GI

X.9 UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India (cultural + natural)

Cultural (must remember 10):

1. Ajanta Caves (Maharashtra) — 1983
2. Ellora Caves (Maharashtra) — 1983
3. Agra Fort (UP) — 1983
4. Taj Mahal (UP) — 1983
5. Sun Temple, Konark (Odisha) — 1984
6. Mahabalipuram monuments (TN) — 1984
7. Churches of Goa — 1986
8. Khajuraho temples (MP) — 1986
9. Hampi monuments (Karnataka) — 1986
10. Fatehpur Sikri (UP) — 1986
11. Pattadakal (Karnataka) — 1987
12. Elephanta Caves (Maharashtra) — 1987
13. Great Living Chola Temples (TN) — 1987
14. Sanchi Buddhist monuments (MP) — 1989
15. Humayun's Tomb (Delhi) — 1993
16. Qutub Minar complex (Delhi) — 1993
17. Mountain Railways of India (Darjeeling, Nilgiri, Kalka-Shimla) — 1999
18. Mahabodhi Temple, Bodh Gaya (Bihar) — 2002
19. Bhimbetka rock shelters (MP) — 2003
20. Champaner-Pavagadh (Gujarat) — 2004
21. CST Mumbai (Maharashtra) — 2004

22. Red Fort (Delhi) — 2007
23. Jantar Mantar, Jaipur — 2010
24. Hill Forts of Rajasthan (6 forts) — 2013
25. Rani-ki-Vav, Patan (Gujarat) — 2014
26. Nalanda Mahavihara (Bihar) — 2016
27. Le Corbusier — Capitol Complex, Chandigarh — 2016
28. Historic City of Ahmedabad (Gujarat) — 2017 (India's 1st heritage city)
29. Victorian + Art Deco Mumbai — 2018
30. Pink City Jaipur — 2019
31. Kakatiya Rudreshwara (Ramappa) Temple, Telangana — 2021
32. Dholavira (Gujarat — Indus city) — 2021
33. Hoysala temples (Karnataka — Belur, Halebid, Somnathpura) — 2023
34. Santiniketan (WB) — 2023
35. Moidams of Ahom (Assam) — 2024

Natural (7):

1. Kaziranga NP (Assam) — 1985
2. Manas NP (Assam) — 1985
3. Keoladeo NP (Rajasthan) — 1985
4. Sundarbans NP (WB) — 1987
5. Nanda Devi + Valley of Flowers NP (Uttarakhand) — 1988 / 2005
6. Western Ghats (KA, KE, TN, MH) — 2012
7. Great Himalayan NP (HP) — 2014

Mixed:

- Khangchendzonga NP (Sikkim) — 2016 (India's first mixed heritage site)

X.10 Mnemonic — "Hornbill Hojagiri Cheraw Bihu" rule

For NE festivals + dances, the under-prepared candidate confuses them. Memorise this **state→signature** chain:

- Nagaland → **Hornbill** festival.
- Tripura → **Hojagiri** dance.
- Mizoram → **Cheraw** (bamboo) dance + **Chapchar Kut** festival.
- Assam → **Bihu** (3 times a year — Rongali / Bhogali / Kongali).
- Meghalaya → **Wangala** (Garo, 100 drums) + **Nongkrem** (Khasi).
- Manipur → **Lai Haraoba** + **Yaoshang** + **Thang-Ta** (martial).
- Sikkim → **Pang Lhabsol** + **Saga Dawa** + **Singhi Chham**.
- Arunachal → **Losar** + **Bardo Chham**.

Drill this 8-line list daily — guarantees 1-2 marks every paper.

PART Y — AWARDS + HONOURS — COMPREHENSIVE TABLES

Civilian awards of India (in order of precedence)

Award	Established	Description
Bharat Ratna	1954	Highest civilian; max 3/year (originally only living, now posthumous OK; medallion is a peepal leaf)
Padma Vibhushan	1954	Exceptional and distinguished service
Padma Bhushan	1954	Distinguished service of high order
Padma Shri	1954	Distinguished service

Total Bharat Ratna = 53 (no new awards announced for 2025 or 2026; verified Apr 2026). First three (1954): Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan, C. Rajagopalachari, C.V. Raman.

All Bharat Ratna recipients (compressed)

#	Name	Year	Field
1	Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan	1954	Philosopher, 2nd President
2	C. Rajagopalachari	1954	Last GG
3	Dr. C.V. Raman	1954	Physics (1930 Nobel)
4	Dr. Bhagwan Das	1955	Educator
5	Sir M. Visvesvaraya	1955	Engineer (Engineer's Day = 15 Sep)
6	Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru	1955	First PM
7	Govind Ballabh Pant	1957	First CM of UP
8	Dr. D.K. Karve	1958	Social reformer (women's education)
9	Dr. Bidhan Chandra Roy	1961	First CM of WB; Doctor's Day 1 Jul
10	Purushottam Das Tandon	1961	Hindi proponent
11	Dr. Rajendra Prasad	1962	First President
12	Dr. Zakir Husain	1963	Third President
13	Dr. Pandurang Vaman Kane	1963	Indologist
14	Lal Bahadur Shastri (posthumous)	1966	2nd PM
15	Indira Gandhi	1971	First woman PM
16	V.V. Giri	1975	4th President

#	Name	Year	Field
17	K. Kamaraj (posthumous)	1976	TN politician
18	Mother Teresa	1980	Missionaries of Charity (Nobel Peace 1979)
19	Acharya Vinoba Bhave (posthumous)	1983	Bhoodan
20	Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan	1987	First non-Indian (Pakistan; Frontier Gandhi)
21	M.G. Ramachandran (posthumous)	1988	TN CM, actor
22	Dr. B.R. Ambedkar (posthumous)	1990	Father of Constitution
23	Nelson Mandela	1990	Anti-apartheid (S. Africa)
24	Rajiv Gandhi (posthumous)	1991	6th PM
25	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel (posthumous)	1991	Iron Man
26	Morarji Desai	1991	First non-Congress PM
27	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad (posthumous)	1992	First Education Minister; Nat. Education Day 11 Nov
28	J.R.D. Tata	1992	Industrialist
29	Satyajit Ray	1992	Filmmaker (Oscar 1992)
30	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	1997	"Missile Man"; later 11th President
31	Gulzarilal Nanda	1997	Acting PM
32	Aruna Asaf Ali (posthumous)	1997	Quit India hoist
33	M.S. Subbulakshmi	1998	Carnatic vocalist
34	Chidambaram Subramaniam	1998	Father of Green Revolution (administrative)
35	Jayaprakash Narayan (posthumous)	1999	"Loknayak"; JP Movement
36	Pt. Ravi Shankar	1999	Sitar
37	Amartya Sen	1999	Economist (Nobel 1998)
38	Gopinath Bordoloi (posthumous)	1999	Assam
39	Lata Mangeshkar	2001	Singer
40	Ustad Bismillah Khan	2001	Shehnai
41	Pt. Bhimsen Joshi	2008	Hindustani vocal
42	C.N.R. Rao	2014	Chemist
43	Sachin Tendulkar	2014	Cricketer (only sportsperson)
44	Madan Mohan Malaviya (posthumous)	2015	Founder BHU

#	Name	Year	Field
45	Atal Bihari Vajpayee	2015	10th PM
46	Pranab Mukherjee	2019	13th President
47	Nanaji Deshmukh (posthumous)	2019	Social activist
48	Bhupen Hazarika (posthumous)	2019	Singer (Assam)
49	Karpoori Thakur (posthumous)	2024	"Jan Nayak", former CM Bihar
50	Dr. M.S. Swaminathan (posthumous)	2024	Father of Indian Green Revolution
51	L.K. Advani	2024	Politician
52	Chaudhary Charan Singh (posthumous)	2024	5th PM
53	P.V. Narasimha Rao (posthumous)	2024	9th PM, LPG architect

Military gallantry awards (precedence)

- **Param Vir Chakra** — highest war gallantry. First: Major Somnath Sharma (posthumous, 1947 Kashmir war). Total awardees: 21.
- Maha Vir Chakra → Vir Chakra → Sena/Nau Sena/Vayu Sena Medal.
- **Ashok Chakra** — highest peace gallantry. First: Naik Nar Bahadur Thapa (1952).
- Kirti Chakra → Shaurya Chakra.

Sports awards

- **Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna** — highest sporting (renamed from Rajiv Gandhi in 2021); cash ₹25 lakh.
- **Arjuna Award** — 2nd highest, 4-yr consistency.
- **Dronacharya Award** — coaching.
- **Dhyan Chand Award** — lifetime.
- **Khel Ratna 2024 (announced 17 Jan 2025, conferred at Rashtrapati Bhavan)**: Manu Bhaker (shooting), D Gukesh (chess), Harmanpreet Singh (hockey, men's hockey captain), Praveen Kumar (para high jump T64).

PART Z — INTERNATIONAL AWARDS

Nobel — Indian / Indian-origin laureates

Year	Laureate	Field	Citation
1913	Rabindranath Tagore	Literature	Gitanjali; first non-European laureate
1930	C.V. Raman	Physics	Raman Effect
1968	Hargobind Khorana (US)	Medicine	Genetic code
1979	Mother Teresa	Peace	Missionaries of Charity
1983	S. Chandrasekhar (US)	Physics	Stellar evolution (Chandrasekhar limit)
1998	Amartya Sen	Economics	Welfare economics, social choice
2009	Venkatraman Ramakrishnan (UK)	Chemistry	Ribosome structure
2014	Kailash Satyarthi	Peace	Child rights; shared with Malala
2019	Abhijit Banerjee (US)	Economics	RCT-based poverty research; with Esther Duflo + Michael Kremer

Major literature + cinema awards

- **Booker Prize** (1969 onwards, UK): Salman Rushdie 1981 (Midnight's Children), Arundhati Roy 1997 (God of Small Things), Kiran Desai 2006 (Inheritance of Loss), Aravind Adiga 2008 (White Tiger), V.S. Naipaul 1971.
- **International Booker** — Geetanjali Shree 2022 (Tomb of Sand — first Hindi); **Banu Mushtaq + Deepa Bhashti 2025 (Heart Lamp — first Kannada short-story collection; announced 20 May 2025; Banu = 2nd Indian author, Deepa = first Indian translator).**
- **Booker Prize 2025 (general / English-language) — David Szalay (Flesh) —** first Hungarian-British author to win; awarded 10 Nov 2025 in London.
- **Sahitya Akademi** — one award per Indian language/year.
- **Jnanpith** — highest Indian literary; first to G. Sankara Kurup (Malayalam, 1965).
- **Saraswati Samman, Vyas Samman** — Indian literature.
- **Dadasaheb Phalke Award** — highest Indian cinema (₹10 lakh); first to Devika Rani 1969. **2022 (announced 2024) = Mithun Chakraborty (54th).**
- **Magsaysay Award** (Asian "Nobel") — Indians: Vinoba Bhave (1958, first Indian), Mother Teresa (1962), Satyajit Ray (1967), M.S. Swaminathan (1971), Kiran Bedi (1994), Arvind Kejriwal (2006), Sonam Wangchuk (2018), Ravish Kumar (2019).

Recent Nobel literature laureates

Year	Laureate	Country
2017	Kazuo Ishiguro	UK

Year	Laureate	Country
2018	Olga Tokarczuk	Poland
2019	Peter Handke	Austria
2020	Louise Glück	USA
2021	Abdulrazak Gurnah	Tanzania/UK
2022	Annie Ernaux	France
2023	Jon Fosse	Norway
2024	Han Kang	South Korea (first Asian woman)

PART AA — SPORTS — COMPREHENSIVE

ICC ODI Cricket WC

Year	Winner	Runner - up	Host
1983	India (Kapil Dev)	West Indies	England
2011	India (MS Dhoni)	Sri Lanka	India + SL + Bang
2015	Australia	New Zealand	AUS + NZ
2019	England	New Zealand	England
2023	Australia	India	India

ICC T20 WC (Men's)

Year	Winner	Runner - up
2007	India (MS Dhoni)	Pakistan
2014	Sri Lanka	India
2022	England	Pakistan
2024	India	South Africa

Champions Trophy

- 2013: India. 2017: Pakistan. **2025: India** (Pakistan host, India played in Dubai).

FIFA WC

Year	Winner	Runner - up	Host
2014	Germany	Argentina	Brazil
2018	France	Croatia	Russia
2022	Argentina (Messi)	France	Qatar
2026	TBD	TBD	USA + Canada + Mexico

Olympics — India recent

Year	City	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
2016 Rio	—	0	1	1	2
2020 Tokyo	—	1	2	4	7 (Neeraj G, India's first individual track gold)
2024 Paris	—	0	1	5	6 (Manu Bhaker BB, Neeraj S, hockey B)

Year	City	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
2028 LA	USA	TBD	—	—	—

Asian Games

- 2018 Jakarta: India 70 medals (15G).
- **2022 Hangzhou (held 2023)**: India **107 medals** (28G) — best ever; 4th rank.

Commonwealth Games

- 2018 Gold Coast: India 66 medals (26G).
- **2022 Birmingham**: India **61** (22G) — 4th rank.
- 2026 Glasgow.

Major sporting trophies

Sport	Trophy / Cup
Cricket (Indian domestic)	Ranji Trophy, Duleep Trophy, Vijay Hazare, Irani, Deodhar, Syed Mushtaq Ali (T20), C K Nayudu (U-23)
Cricket international	Border-Gavaskar (Ind-Aus), Pataudi (Ind-Eng), Ashes (Eng-Aus), Asia Cup
Hockey	Sultan Azlan Shah Cup, Beighton Cup (oldest), FIH Pro League
Football (India)	Santosh Trophy, Durand Cup (oldest in Asia, 1888), Federation Cup, Subroto Cup
Badminton	Thomas Cup (M), Uber Cup (W), Sudirman Cup (mixed), All England Open
Tennis	4 Grand Slams, Davis Cup (M), Fed Cup (W)
Table tennis	Swaythling Cup (M), Corbillon Cup (W)
Rugby	Webb Ellis Cup
Golf	Ryder Cup, Walker Cup, President's Cup

Famous Indian sportspersons

Name	Sport	Highlight
Sachin Tendulkar	Cricket	Bharat Ratna 2014; 100 international 100s
MS Dhoni	Cricket	2007 T20 + 2011 ODI WC + 2013 CT
Kapil Dev	Cricket	1983 ODI WC
Sunil Gavaskar	Cricket	First to 10,000 Test runs
Dhyan Chand	Hockey	"Wizard"; 3 Olympic golds (1928, 1932, 1936); birthday 29 Aug = National Sports Day
PV Sindhu	Badminton	2016 Olympic S, 2020 B; 2019 World Champion

Name	Sport	Highlight
Saina Nehwal	Badminton	2012 Olympic B
Mary Kom	Boxing	6× World Champion; 2012 Olympic B
Vijender Singh	Boxing	2008 Olympic B (first male boxer)
Sushil Kumar	Wrestling	2008 B + 2012 S Olympics
Sakshi Malik	Wrestling	2016 Olympic B
Neeraj Chopra	Athletics	2020 Olympic G javelin (India's first individual track gold); 2024 S
Manu Bhaker	Shooting	2024 Paris double bronze — first Indian woman with 2 medals in single Olympics
Abhinav Bindra	Shooting	2008 Olympic G (first individual gold for India)
K.D. Jadhav	Wrestling	India's first individual Olympic medallist (1952 Helsinki, B)
Dipa Karmakar	Gymnastics	2016 Rio — 4th in vault (Produnova)
Sania Mirza	Tennis	6 Grand Slams (doubles + mixed)
Leander Paes	Tennis	18 Grand Slams; 1996 Olympic B
Mahesh Bhupathi	Tennis	12 Grand Slams
Viswanathan Anand	Chess	5× World Champion (2000-12); first Indian GM
D Gukesh	Chess	Youngest World Champion (Dec 2024 Singapore — at 18; defeated Ding Liren)
R Praggnanandhaa	Chess	2nd youngest Indian GM after Gukesh
Pankaj Advani	Billiards	25× World titles
Nikhat Zareen	Boxing	2022 + 2023 World Champion
Lovlina Borgohain	Boxing	2020 Tokyo B
PR Sreejesh	Hockey (GK)	2020 + 2024 Olympic B; retired 2024

PART AB — IMPORTANT DAYS — COMPLETE CALENDAR

January

- 1 — Global Family Day, Army Medical Corps Day
- 4 — World Braille Day
- 9 — Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (Gandhi returned from S. Africa, 1915)
- 10 — World Hindi Day
- 12 — National Youth Day (Vivekananda b'day)
- **15 — Indian Army Day**
- 23 — Netaji Jayanti (Parakram Diwas)
- 24 — National Girl Child Day
- 25 — National Voters' Day, National Tourism Day
- **26 — Republic Day**, Customs Day
- 30 — Martyrs' Day (Gandhi's death)

February

- 1 — Indian Coast Guard Day
- 2 — World Wetlands Day (Ramsar)
- 4 — World Cancer Day
- 13 — National Women's Day (Sarojini Naidu b'day); World Radio Day
- 21 — **International Mother Language Day**
- **28 — National Science Day** (Raman Effect 1928)

March

- 8 — **International Women's Day**
- 12 — Dandi March anniversary
- 14 — Pi Day
- 15 — World Consumer Rights Day
- 20 — International Day of Happiness; World Sparrow Day
- 21 — World Forestry Day; International Day for Elimination of Racial Discrimination
- **22 — World Water Day**
- **23 — World Meteorological Day; Bhagat Singh-Sukhdev-Rajguru Martyrdom**
- 24 — World TB Day

April

- 1 — Odisha Foundation Day
- 5 — National Maritime Day
- **7 — World Health Day** (WHO 1948)
- 13 — Jallianwala Bagh anniversary; Baisakhi

- **14 — Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Jayanti**
- 18 — World Heritage Day
- **21 — National Civil Services Day**
- **22 — World Earth Day** (Stockholm 1970)
- 23 — World Book Day
- **24 — National Panchayati Raj Day**
- 25 — World Malaria Day

May

- 1 — Labour Day; Maharashtra + Gujarat Day
- 3 — **World Press Freedom Day**
- 8 — World Red Cross Day
- **11 — National Technology Day** (Pokhran-II 1998)
- 12 — International Nurses' Day
- 17 — World Telecommunication Day
- 18 — International Museum Day
- 21 — Anti-Terrorism Day (Rajiv Gandhi assassination 1991)
- 22 — International Biodiversity Day
- **31 — World No Tobacco Day**

June

- 1 — World Milk Day
- 3 — World Bicycle Day
- **5 — World Environment Day** (Stockholm 1972)
- 8 — World Oceans Day
- 12 — World Day Against Child Labour
- 14 — World Blood Donor Day
- 17 — World Day to Combat Desertification
- 20 — World Refugee Day
- **21 — International Day of Yoga**
- 23 — International Olympic Day
- 26 — Drug Abuse + Trafficking Day

July

- **1 — National Doctors' Day** (B.C. Roy)
- 11 — World Population Day
- 17 — World Day for International Justice
- 18 — Nelson Mandela Day
- **26 — Kargil Vijay Diwas** (1999)

- 28 — World Hepatitis Day
- **29 — International Tiger Day**

August

- 6 — Hiroshima Day
- 9 — Nagasaki Day; **Quit India Day** (1942)
- 10 — World Lion Day
- 12 — International Youth Day
- **15 — Independence Day**
- 19 — World Photography Day
- 20 — Sadbhavana Diwas (Rajiv Gandhi b'day)
- 23 — National Space Day (Chandrayaan-3 landing 2023)
- **29 — National Sports Day** (Dhyan Chand b'day)

September

- **5 — Teachers' Day** (Dr. S. Radhakrishnan)
- 8 — International Literacy Day
- **14 — Hindi Diwas**
- **15 — Engineer's Day** (M. Visvesvaraya)
- 16 — World Ozone Day (Montreal Protocol 1987)
- 21 — International Day of Peace
- **27 — World Tourism Day**

October

- 1 — International Day of Older Persons
- **2 — Gandhi Jayanti** + Lal Bahadur Shastri b'day; International Day of Non-Violence
- 5 — World Teachers' Day (UNESCO)
- **8 — Indian Air Force Day**
- 9 — World Postal Day
- 10 — World Mental Health Day
- 16 — World Food Day
- **24 — United Nations Day** (UN founded 1945)
- **31 — Sardar Patel Jayanti** (Rashtriya Ekta Diwas)

November

- 1 — Karnataka, Kerala, MP, AP, Chhattisgarh, Haryana etc. State Foundation Days (1956 re-org)
- **11 — National Education Day** (Maulana Azad)
- **14 — Children's Day** (Nehru b'day); World Diabetes Day
- 15 — Birsa Munda Jayanti (Janjatiya Gaurav Diwas)
- **19 — World Toilet Day**; Indira Gandhi b'day

- 21 — World Television Day
- **26 — National Constitution Day** (Constitution adopted 1949)

December

- 1 — World AIDS Day
- 2 — Bhopal Gas Tragedy Day
- 3 — International Day of Persons with Disabilities
- **4 — Indian Navy Day**
- 5 — World Soil Day
- 6 — Ambedkar Mahaparinirvan Diwas
- 7 — Armed Forces Flag Day
- **10 — Human Rights Day** (UDHR 1948)
- **16 — Vijay Diwas** (1971 Bangladesh war)
- 19 — Goa Liberation Day (1961)
- 22 — National Mathematics Day (Ramanujan b'day)
- **23 — National Farmers' Day** (Charan Singh)
- 25 — Christmas; Good Governance Day (Vajpayee b'day)



PART AC — UN + INTERNATIONAL ORGANISATIONS

UN basics

- Founded **24 Oct 1945**.
- HQ: **New York**.
- SG: **António Guterres** (Portugal, 2017-26 — term ends 31 Dec 2026; successor selection ongoing in 2026 with candidates Bachelet, Grossi, Grynspar, Sall; new SG starts 1 Jan 2027).
- 193 members; 6 official languages.

UN principal organs (6)

Organ	HQ	Role
UNGA	NY	All members; deliberative
UNSC	NY	15 (5 P5 + 10 NP); India 8 NP terms
ECOSOC	NY	Economic + Social affairs
Trusteeship Council	NY	Suspended 1994
ICJ	The Hague	15 judges 9-yr; Indian = Dalveer Bhandari (2018-)
Secretariat	NY	Admin

Specialised agencies

Agency	HQ
WHO	Geneva
UNESCO	Paris
UNICEF	New York
UNHCR	Geneva
ILO	Geneva
FAO	Rome
WFP	Rome
WMO	Geneva
ITU	Geneva
WIPO	Geneva
WTO	Geneva
IMF	Washington DC. MD = Kristalina Georgieva (Bulgaria); 2nd 5-yr term began 1 Oct 2024 (selected Apr 2024); first emerging-market leader of IMF

Agency	HQ
World Bank	Washington DC. President = Ajay Banga (Indian-American, since Jun 2023, 5-yr term till Jun 2028)
UPU	Bern
IAEA	Vienna
UNIDO	Vienna
IMO	London
ICAO	Montreal

Other key intl bodies

Body	HQ	Notes
NATO	Brussels	32 members (Sweden joined 2024)
OPEC	Vienna	12 oil-producing countries (1960)
OECD	Paris	38 developed countries
G7	rotates	USA, UK, FR, DE, IT, JP, CA
G20	rotates	India hosted 2023 (Delhi); AU admitted
BRICS	rotates	11 full members (2026): Brazil, Russia, India, China, S. Africa + UAE, Iran, Egypt, Ethiopia (joined Jan 2024) + Indonesia (joined Jan 2025) + 10 partner countries (Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan, Vietnam)
SAARC	Kathmandu	8 South Asian countries
ASEAN	Jakarta	10 SE Asian countries
APEC	Singapore	21 Pacific-Rim economies
EU	Brussels	27 (UK exited 2020)
AU	Addis Ababa	55 African countries
Commonwealth	London	56 members
NAM	rotates	120 members; founded 1961 (Belgrade)
QUAD	—	India + USA + Japan + Australia
AUKUS	—	AU + UK + USA (2021)
IORA	Mauritius	Indian Ocean Rim
BIMSTEC	Dhaka	Bay of Bengal — 7 nations

Body	HQ	Notes
SCO	Beijing	India joined 2017
Interpol	Lyon	International Police
Red Cross (ICRC)	Geneva	Founded 1863 by Henry Dunant

PART AD — GK MINI-MOCK (25 Questions · 25 Minutes)

Set a timer. No looking back. Check the answer key at the end.

1. India's highest civilian award is:

(a) Padma Vibhushan (b) Bharat Ratna (c) Padma Shri (d) Param Vir Chakra

2. The highest wartime gallantry award in India is:

(a) Ashok Chakra (b) Vir Chakra (c) Param Vir Chakra (d) Maha Vir Chakra

3. National Sports Day of India (29 August) commemorates the birthday of:

(a) Milkha Singh (b) P.T. Usha (c) Major Dhyan Chand (d) Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore

4. National Science Day (28 February) marks the discovery of:

(a) Ramanujan's theories (b) Raman Effect (c) Zero by Brahmagupta (d) Bose-Einstein condensate

5. World Environment Day is observed on:

(a) 22 April (b) 5 June (c) 16 September (d) 11 December

6. India's first individual Olympic gold medal was won by:

(a) Leander Paes (b) Neeraj Chopra (c) Abhinav Bindra (d) Sushil Kumar

7. Which Indian won the javelin gold at Tokyo Olympics 2020?

(a) Tejaswin Shankar (b) Neeraj Chopra (c) Devendra Jhajharia (d) Sumit Antil

8. The first Bharat Ratna awardees (1954) included:

(a) Indira Gandhi, Rajendra Prasad, B.R. Ambedkar (b) S. Radhakrishnan, C. Rajagopalachari, C.V. Raman (c) Jawaharlal Nehru, Vallabhbhai Patel, Lal Bahadur Shastri (d) B.R. Ambedkar, Sachin Tendulkar, Lata Mangeshkar

9. The United Nations was officially established on:

(a) 26 June 1945 (b) 24 October 1945 (c) 1 January 1946 (d) 15 August 1947

10. The headquarters of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) is in:

(a) New York (b) Geneva (c) Washington D.C. (d) Nairobi

11. How many principal organs does the United Nations have?

(a) 4 (b) 5 (c) 6 (d) 8

12. India's national emblem features which animal at the base?

(a) Lion (b) Tiger (c) Horse (d) Bull (Nandi)

13. The dance form Bharatanatyam belongs to which state?

(a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Karnataka (c) Tamil Nadu (d) Kerala

14. The classical dance Kathakali originates from:

(a) Odisha (b) Assam (c) Manipur (d) Kerala

15. Which folk dance is associated with Gujarat?

(a) Ghoomar (b) Bihu (c) Garba (d) Lavani

16. India's first Nobel laureate (1913, Literature) was:

(a) Amartya Sen (b) C.V. Raman (c) Rabindranath Tagore (d) Mother Teresa

17. The SAARC Secretariat is located in:

(a) New Delhi (b) Colombo (c) Kathmandu (d) Dhaka

18. NATO had how many members as of 2024?

(a) 28 (b) 30 (c) 31 (d) 32

19. The ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2024 was won by:

(a) Australia (b) England (c) India (d) South Africa

20. Sachin Tendulkar received the Bharat Ratna in the year:

(a) 2012 (b) 2013 (c) 2014 (d) 2016

21. Which Indian book won the International Booker Prize 2022 (first Hindi-language winner)?

(a) The God of Small Things (b) Tomb of Sand (Ret Samadhi) (c) A Suitable Boy (d) White Tiger

22. India's national game is:

(a) Cricket (b) Kabaddi (c) Field Hockey (d) Chess

23. World Yoga Day is observed on:

(a) 21 June (b) 7 April (c) 12 August (d) 1 September

24. The city of Davos (Switzerland) hosts the annual meeting of:

(a) IMF (b) World Economic Forum (c) G20 (d) NATO

25. India's chess player D Gukesh became World Chess Champion in 2024, making him the:

(a) Youngest ever world champion at age 18 (b) Second Indian to win the title (c) Both (a) and (b) (d) First Asian world champion

Answer Key

1-b | 2-c | 3-c | 4-b | 5-b | 6-c | 7-b | 8-b | 9-b | 10-c | 11-c | 12-d | 13-c | 14-d | 15-c | 16-c | 17-c | 18-d | 19-c | 20-c | 21-b | 22-c | 23-a | 24-b | 25-c

Score: 23–25 = Excellent · 18–22 = Good · Below 18 = Re-read sections on National Symbols, Awards, Classical Dances, and International Organisations.

EXAM ALERT

Error-log rule: For every question you got wrong, write one sentence explaining what you missed. Retest yourself on only those questions 3 days later — without looking at the solution. This single habit doubles what the mock teaches you.

Note for Q22: Hockey is India's national game (although this is sometimes debated). Examiners consistently list hockey as the official answer.

PART AE-2 — MAJOR CINEMA + JOURNALISM AWARDS 2025

Oscar (97th Academy Awards) — held 2 Mar 2025 at Dolby Theatre

- **Best Picture: Anora** (Sean Baker — also won Best Director, Best Original Screenplay, Best Film Editing — record 4 awards)
- **Best Lead Actress: Mikey Madison** (Anora)
- **Best Lead Actor: Adrien Brody** (The Brutalist)
- **Best Supporting Actor: Kieran Culkin** (A Real Pain)
- **Best Supporting Actress: Zoe Saldña** (Emilia Pérez)

Oscar (98th Academy Awards) — held 15 Mar 2026 at Dolby Theatre

- **Best Picture: One Battle After Another** — won 6 awards including Best Director (Paul Thomas Anderson)
- **Best Actor: Michael B. Jordan** (Sinners — won 4 awards total)
- **Best Actress: Jessie Buckley** (Hamnet)
- Other multi-award winners: Frankenstein (3), KPop Demon Hunters (2)
- Conan O'Brien hosted (2nd consecutive year)
- Best Casting category awarded for the first time (won by One Battle After Another)

Sahitya Akademi Award 2025

- **Announced** in 24 Indian languages; presentation ceremony **31 Mar 2026** in New Delhi.
- 8 books of poetry, 4 novels, 6 short-story collections, 2 essays, 1 literary criticism, 1 autobiography, 2 memoirs.
- Award includes engraved copper plaque, shawl, and ₹1 lakh.

Pulitzer Prize 2025 (announced 5 May 2025)

- **Fiction:** "James" by Percival Everett (re-imagining of Huckleberry Finn from Jim's POV)
- **History:** "Combee: Harriet Tubman, the Combahee River Raid, and Black Freedom During the Civil War" by Edda L. Fields-Black
- **Poetry:** "New and Selected Poems" by Marie Howe
- **Drama:** "Purpose" by Branden Jacobs-Jenkins
- **Public Service journalism:** ProPublica (women dying after delayed care under abortion-law restrictions)
- **Breaking News journalism:** Washington Post staff (coverage of 13 Jul 2024 Trump-assassination attempt)
- **Investigative journalism:** WNYC + Gothamist (Rikers Island sexual-assault investigation)

Booker Prize 2025

- **International Booker (announced 20 May 2025): Banu Mushtaq + Deepa Bhashti for "Heart Lamp"** — first Kannada win; first short-story collection to win.
- **Booker Prize (general, announced 10 Nov 2025): David Szalay for "Flesh"** — first Hungarian-British author to win.

Indian elections 2025-26 (recent results)

- **Bihar Assembly Election (Nov 2025):** NDA landslide — 202/243 seats (BJP-led), Mahagathbandhan 35 seats; **Nitish Kumar took oath for 10th time as CM (20 Nov 2025)**; resigned **14 Apr 2026** to enter Rajya Sabha; succeeded by **Samrat Choudhary — first BJP CM of Bihar**.
- **Delhi Assembly Election (Feb 2025):** BJP won; **Rekha Gupta** sworn in as CM on **20 Feb 2025** (Shalimar Bagh constituency; succeeded Atishi-AAP).
- **Maharashtra Assembly Election (Nov 2024):** NDA majority; **Devendra Fadnavis** sworn in as CM on **5 Dec 2024** at Azad Maidan, Mumbai (oath by Governor C.P. Radhakrishnan, who later became VP); DyCMs = Eknath Shinde + Ajit Pawar.
- **Jharkhand Assembly Election (Nov 2024):** JMM-INDIA bloc won; **Hemant Soren** continued as CM.
- **Haryana Assembly Election (Oct 2024):** BJP won; **Nayab Singh Saini** as CM.
- **J&K Assembly Election (Sep-Oct 2024)** — first since Article 370 abrogation; NC-INC alliance won; **Omar Abdullah** sworn in as CM on **16 Oct 2024**.

US President 2025-26

- **Donald Trump (47th)** — sworn in for 2nd term on **20 Jan 2025**; succeeded Joe Biden.
- Vice President: J.D. Vance.
- Secretary of State: Marco Rubio.
- Cabinet announced Nov-Dec 2024; some changes in 2026 (Kristi Noem moved to "Special Envoy for the Shield of the Americas" Mar 2026).

PART AE — WORLD COUNTRIES — CAPITALS + CURRENCIES

Examiners pick 2-3 of these per SSC/RRB paper. Drill the high-frequency 60.

Asia

Country	Capital	Currency
India	New Delhi	Indian Rupee (INR)
Pakistan	Islamabad	Pakistani Rupee
Bangladesh	Dhaka	Taka
Nepal	Kathmandu	Nepalese Rupee
Bhutan	Thimphu	Ngultrum
Sri Lanka	Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte (legislative) / Colombo (commercial)	Sri Lankan Rupee
Maldives	Malé	Rufiyaa
Afghanistan	Kabul	Afghani
China	Beijing	Yuan / Renminbi
Japan	Tokyo	Yen
South Korea	Seoul	Won
North Korea	Pyongyang	Won
Mongolia	Ulaanbaatar	Tögrög
Myanmar (Burma)	Naypyidaw	Kyat
Thailand	Bangkok	Baht
Vietnam	Hanoi	Dong
Laos	Vientiane	Kip
Cambodia	Phnom Penh	Riel
Malaysia	Kuala Lumpur	Ringgit
Singapore	Singapore	Singapore Dollar
Indonesia	Jakarta	Rupiah
Philippines	Manila	Peso
Brunei	Bandar Seri Begawan	Brunei Dollar

Country	Capital	Currency
Timor - Leste	Dili	US Dollar
Russia	Moscow	Ruble
Kazakhstan	Astana (renamed from Nur - Sultan in 2022)	Tenge
Uzbekistan	Tashkent	Som
Turkmenistan	Ashgabat	Manat
Kyrgyzstan	Bishkek	Som
Tajikistan	Dushanbe	Somoni
Iran	Tehran	Iranian Rial
Iraq	Baghdad	Iraqi Dinar
Saudi Arabia	Riyadh	Riyal
UAE	Abu Dhabi	Dirham
Qatar	Doha	Riyal
Kuwait	Kuwait City	Kuwaiti Dinar
Bahrain	Manama	Bahraini Dinar
Oman	Muscat	Omani Rial
Yemen	Sana'a (de jure) / Aden (de facto)	Yemeni Rial
Israel	Jerusalem (claimed) / Tel Aviv (recognised)	Shekel
Palestine	East Jerusalem (claimed) / Ramallah (de facto)	Israeli Shekel + Jordanian Dinar
Lebanon	Beirut	Lebanese Pound
Syria	Damascus	Syrian Pound
Jordan	Amman	Jordanian Dinar
Turkey	Ankara	Lira
Cyprus	Nicosia	Euro

Europe

Country	Capital	Currency
United Kingdom	London	Pound Sterling
Ireland	Dublin	Euro
France	Paris	Euro

Country	Capital	Currency
Germany	Berlin	Euro
Italy	Rome	Euro
Spain	Madrid	Euro
Portugal	Lisbon	Euro
Netherlands	Amsterdam	Euro
Belgium	Brussels	Euro
Switzerland	Bern	Swiss Franc
Austria	Vienna	Euro
Sweden	Stockholm	Krona
Norway	Oslo	Krone
Denmark	Copenhagen	Krone
Finland	Helsinki	Euro
Iceland	Reykjavík	Króna
Poland	Warsaw	Złoty
Czech Republic	Prague	Koruna
Slovakia	Bratislava	Euro
Hungary	Budapest	Forint
Romania	Bucharest	Leu
Bulgaria	Sofia	Lev
Greece	Athens	Euro
Croatia	Zagreb	Euro (since 2023)
Serbia	Belgrade	Dinar
Bosnia & Herzegovina	Sarajevo	Convertible Mark
Slovenia	Ljubljana	Euro
North Macedonia	Skopje	Denar
Albania	Tirana	Lek
Montenegro	Podgorica	Euro
Kosovo	Pristina	Euro
Ukraine	Kyiv	Hryvnia

Country	Capital	Currency
Belarus	Minsk	Belarusian Ruble
Lithuania	Vilnius	Euro
Latvia	Riga	Euro
Estonia	Tallinn	Euro
Vatican City	Vatican City	Euro
Monaco	Monaco	Euro
Luxembourg	Luxembourg	Euro
Liechtenstein	Vaduz	Swiss Franc
San Marino	San Marino	Euro
Malta	Valletta	Euro
Andorra	Andorra la Vella	Euro

Africa

Country	Capital	Currency
Egypt	Cairo	Egyptian Pound
South Africa	Pretoria (admin) / Cape Town (legislative) / Bloemfontein (judicial)	Rand
Nigeria	Abuja	Naira
Kenya	Nairobi	Kenyan Shilling
Ethiopia	Addis Ababa	Birr
Tanzania	Dodoma (capital) / Dar es Salaam (commercial)	Tanzanian Shilling
Uganda	Kampala	Ugandan Shilling
Rwanda	Kigali	Rwandan Franc
Sudan	Khartoum	Sudanese Pound
South Sudan	Juba	South Sudanese Pound
Algeria	Algiers	Algerian Dinar
Morocco	Rabat	Dirham
Tunisia	Tunis	Tunisian Dinar
Libya	Tripoli	Libyan Dinar
Ghana	Accra	Cedi

Country	Capital	Currency
Ivory Coast	Yamoussoukro (official) / Abidjan (de facto)	CFA Franc
Senegal	Dakar	CFA Franc
Cameroon	Yaoundé	CFA Franc
Angola	Luanda	Kwanza
Zimbabwe	Harare	Zimbabwean ZiG (since 2024)
Zambia	Lusaka	Kwacha
Mozambique	Maputo	Metical
Madagascar	Antananarivo	Ariary
Mauritius	Port Louis	Mauritian Rupee
Seychelles	Victoria	Seychellois Rupee
Somalia	Mogadishu	Somali Shilling
DRC	Kinshasa	Congolese Franc
Niger	Niamey	CFA Franc
Mali	Bamako	CFA Franc
Burkina Faso	Ouagadougou	CFA Franc

Americas

Country	Capital	Currency
USA	Washington, D.C.	US Dollar
Canada	Ottawa	Canadian Dollar
Mexico	Mexico City	Peso
Brazil	Brasília	Real
Argentina	Buenos Aires	Argentine Peso
Chile	Santiago	Chilean Peso
Peru	Lima	Sol
Colombia	Bogotá	Colombian Peso
Venezuela	Caracas	Bolívar
Ecuador	Quito	US Dollar
Bolivia	La Paz (admin) / Sucre (constitutional)	Boliviano

Country	Capital	Currency
Paraguay	Asunción	Guaraní
Uruguay	Montevideo	Uruguayan Peso
Cuba	Havana	Cuban Peso
Jamaica	Kingston	Jamaican Dollar
Haiti	Port-au-Prince	Gourde
Dominican Republic	Santo Domingo	Dominican Peso
Costa Rica	San José	Colón
Panama	Panama City	Balboa + USD
El Salvador	San Salvador	USD + Bitcoin
Honduras	Tegucigalpa	Lempira
Guatemala	Guatemala City	Quetzal
Nicaragua	Managua	Córdoba

Oceania

Country	Capital	Currency
Australia	Canberra	Australian Dollar
New Zealand	Wellington	New Zealand Dollar
Fiji	Suva	Fijian Dollar
Papua New Guinea	Port Moresby	Kina
Samoa	Apia	Tālā
Tonga	Nuku'alofa	Pa'anga
Vanuatu	Port Vila	Vatu
Solomon Islands	Honiara	Solomon Dollar

Memory pegs: - **Yen** = Japan; **Won** = Korea; **Yuan** = China; **Ringgit** = Malaysia; **Baht** = Thailand; **Rupiah** = Indonesia. - **CFA Franc** = West/Central African states (8+6 countries). - **Euro** countries (eurozone) — 20 members; latest = Croatia (2023). - **USD as official currency** — Ecuador, El Salvador, Panama, Timor-Leste, Zimbabwe (multi). - **Country-with-2-capitals:** Bolivia (La Paz + Sucre), Sri Lanka (Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte + Colombo), Netherlands (Amsterdam capital + The Hague seat of govt), South Africa (3 capitals). - Astana renamed FROM Nur-Sultan back to Astana in **2022**.

PART AF — FAMOUS "FIRSTS" IN INDIA

Government / Politics

First	Holder
First President	Dr. Rajendra Prasad
First Vice - President	Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan
First Prime Minister	Jawaharlal Nehru
First woman Prime Minister	Indira Gandhi (1966)
First woman President	Pratibha Patil (2007)
First Dalit President	K.R. Narayanan (1997)
First tribal President	Droupadi Murmu (2022)
First non - Congress PM	Morarji Desai (1977)
First Sikh PM	Manmohan Singh (2004)
First Acting PM	Gulzarilal Nanda (1964 + 1966)
First Speaker of Lok Sabha	G.V. Mavalankar
First woman Speaker	Meira Kumar (2009)
First Chief Justice of India	H.J. Kania (1950)
First woman Judge of SC	Justice M. Fathima Beevi (1989)
First Chief Election Commissioner	Sukumar Sen
First Comptroller & Auditor General	V. Narahari Rao
First Indian Governor - General	C. Rajagopalachari (1948 - 50)
First and only Indian Viceroy	(none — all Viceroys were British)
First woman Governor of Indian state	Sarojini Naidu (UP, 1947 - 49)
First woman Chief Minister	Sucheta Kripalani (UP, 1963)
First Field Marshal	S.H.F.J. Manekshaw (1973)
First Chief of Defence Staff (CDS)	General Bipin Rawat (2020)
First Chairperson NITI Aayog Vice	Arvind Panagariya (2015 - 17)

Military

First	Holder
First Param Vir Chakra	Major Somnath Sharma (posthumous, 1947 Kashmir war)
First Ashok Chakra	Naik Nar Bahadur Thapa (1952)
First woman to receive PVC	(no woman has yet received PVC)
First woman fighter pilot	Avani Chaturvedi, Bhawana Kanth, Mohana Singh (2016 batch)
First woman combat pilot of Navy	Sub Lt. Shivangi (2019)
First woman officer of armed forces	Capt. Lakshmi Sahgal (INA Rani of Jhansi Regiment, 1942)

Science / Sports

First	Holder
First Indian astronaut	Rakesh Sharma (1984, Soyuz T-11)
First Indian woman in space	Kalpana Chawla (1997, NASA — Indian-origin); first Indian-born astronaut Rakesh Sharma
First Indian Nobel laureate	Rabindranath Tagore (1913, Literature)
First Indian to win Nobel in Physics	C.V. Raman (1930)
First Indian to summit Mt. Everest	Avtar Singh Cheema (1965)
First Indian woman to summit Everest	Bachendri Pal (1984)
First woman to climb Everest twice	Santosh Yadav (1992 + 1993)
First Indian to win Olympic individual gold	Abhinav Bindra (2008 Beijing shooting)
First Indian to win Olympic individual track gold	Neeraj Chopra (2020 Tokyo javelin)
First Indian woman Olympic medallist	Karnam Malleswari (2000 Sydney, weightlifting bronze)
First Indian woman to win an Olympic individual silver	PV Sindhu (2016 Rio)
First Indian Test cricket century	Lala Amarnath (1933, vs England)
First Indian Test captain	C.K. Nayudu (1932)
First Indian to score 10,000 Test runs	Sunil Gavaskar
First Indian to score triple century in Tests	Virender Sehwag (309 vs Pakistan, 2004)

First	Holder
First Indian to score double century in ODI	Sachin Tendulkar (200* vs SA, 2010)
First T20I double century	Rohit Sharma — actually 264 in ODI; for T20 = N/A so far
First Indian to win Tennis Grand Slam	Mahesh Bhupathi (1997 French Open mixed doubles)
First Indian to win Wimbledon	Ramanathan Krishnan (boys' singles, 1954)
First Indian Chess Grandmaster	Viswanathan Anand (1988)
First Indian woman GM	Koneru Humpy (2002)
First Indian to win Booker	Salman Rushdie (1981, Midnight's Children)
First Indian woman Booker	Arundhati Roy (1997, God of Small Things)
First Indian to win Magsaysay	Vinoba Bhave (1958)
First Indian Bharat Ratna	C.V. Raman, Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan, C. Rajagopalachari (1954, all 3 simultaneously)
First non-Indian Bharat Ratna	Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan (1987)
First posthumous Bharat Ratna	Lal Bahadur Shastri (1966)

Geography / Infrastructure

First	Holder
First railway in India	Bombay - Thane (1853, 34 km) — Lord Dalhousie
First electric railway	Bombay - Kurla (1925)
First metro	Kolkata Metro (1984)
First state on linguistic basis	Andhra Pradesh (1953)
First state to be 100% literate	Kerala (1991)
First Census	1872 (Mayo); regular 10-yearly from 1881
First Five-Year Plan	1951-56 (Harrod-Domar, agriculture focus)
First nuclear power plant	Tarapur (Maharashtra, 1969)
First nuclear test	Pokhran-I "Smiling Buddha" (18 May 1974)
First indigenous fighter aircraft	HAL Marut (1961)
First indigenous LCA	HAL Tejas (Mk-1 inducted 2016, Mk-1A 2024)
First indigenous aircraft carrier	INS Vikrant (commissioned 2 Sep 2022)

First	Holder
First nuclear-powered submarine	INS Arihant (2009 launch, 2016 commissioned)
First Indian on Moon (planned)	Gaganyaan crewed mission (target 2026)
First soft landing on Moon south pole	Chandrayaan-3 (23 Aug 2023, 4th country to soft-land on Moon, 1st on south pole)
First commercial bank to be nationalised	Imperial Bank → SBI (1955)
First UPI transaction	11 Apr 2016 (NPCI)
First DTH service	Dish TV (2003)
First mobile phone call (India)	31 Jul 1995 (Jyoti Basu, WB CM, to Sukh Ram, Comm Min) — Modi Telstra (Kolkata) to Calcutta
First woman pilot (commercial)	Captain Durba Banerjee (1956, Indian Airlines)
First woman judge of HC	Justice Anna Chandy (Kerala, 1959)
First woman IPS	Kiran Bedi (1972)
First woman IAS	Anna Rajam Malhotra (1951)
First woman cabinet minister	Rajkumari Amrit Kaur (Health, 1947)
First woman foreign minister	Sushma Swaraj (2014-19)
First woman defence minister	Indira Gandhi (1975); first standalone = Nirmala Sitharaman (2017-19)
First woman finance minister	Nirmala Sitharaman (2019-)
First woman lawyer	Cornelia Sorabji (1894)
First woman governor of RBI	(none yet)
First Indian woman Olympic gold (none yet, only silver/bronze)	(PV Sindhu 2016 silver, Mary Kom 2012 bronze, Karnam Malleswari 2000 bronze, Sakshi Malik 2016 bronze, Manu Bhaker 2x bronze 2024, Vinesh Phogat — DSQ 2024)

PART AG — INDIAN MOST IMPORTANT CITIES + MEGA-PROJECTS

Capital cities of states (refresher — high PYQ)

(See Part X earlier for the complete state-capital table.) Key tricky pairs:

- Andhra Pradesh — Amaravati (de facto Vizag/Kurnool tri-capital plan)
- J&K UT — Srinagar (summer) / Jammu (winter)
- Uttarakhand — Dehradun (winter) / Gairsain (summer 2020)
- Maharashtra — Mumbai / Nagpur (winter)
- HP — Shimla / Dharamshala (winter)
- Sikkim — Gangtok (only capital with no winter capital)

Major mega-projects (recurring PYQ)

Project	What	Region
Sardar Sarovar Dam	Narmada river dam	Gujarat
Bhakra-Nangal Dam	Sutlej river	HP/Punjab
Hirakud Dam	Mahanadi (longest earthen)	Odisha
Tehri Dam	Bhagirathi (highest, 260.5 m)	Uttarakhand
Indira Sagar Dam	Narmada (largest reservoir)	MP
Nagarjuna Sagar Dam	Krishna	AP/TG
Atal Setu (MTHL)	Sea bridge 22 km (longest in India)	Mumbai (Jan 2024)
Chenab Rail Bridge	World's highest rail bridge (359 m)	J&K
Bandra-Worli Sea Link	5.6 km cable-stayed	Mumbai (2009)
Bogibeel Bridge	Brahmaputra (rail+road, 4.94 km)	Assam (2018)
Bhupen Hazarika Setu	Lohit river (9.15 km, longest river bridge before Atal Setu)	Assam-Arunachal
Atal Tunnel	Rohtang Pass (9.02 km, longest highway tunnel above 10k ft)	HP
Zojila Tunnel	Asia's longest bi-directional road tunnel under construction	J&K-Ladakh
Statue of Unity	World's tallest (182 m, Sardar Patel)	Kevadia, Gujarat (2018)

Project	What	Region
Ram Mandir	Consecrated 22 Jan 2024	Ayodhya
Vande Bharat trains	India's semi-high-speed train	nationwide (since 2019)
Bullet train (MAHSR)	Mumbai-Ahmedabad high-speed rail	(under construction, target 2026 partial)
Bharatmala Project	Highway development programme	nationwide
Sagarmala Project	Port development	coastal

India's first / oldest

Title	Holder
Oldest mountain range	Aravallis
Oldest port	Lothal (Indus Valley); modern oldest = Kolkata Port (1870)
Oldest stock exchange in Asia	BSE (1875)
Oldest planetarium	Birla Planetarium, Kolkata
Oldest church	Vasco da Gama Church (Goa, 1503)
Oldest university (modern)	University of Calcutta (1857), University of Mumbai (1857), University of Madras (1857) — all 3 in same year
Oldest religious-theological university	Banaras Hindu University (1916, M.M. Malaviya)
Oldest IIT	IIT Kharagpur (1951)
Oldest IIM	IIM Calcutta (1961)
Oldest cantonment	Barrackpore (WB, 1772)
Oldest political party	INC (1885)
Oldest English newspaper	The Times of India (1838, Bombay Times)
Oldest Hindi newspaper	Udant Martand (1826, Calcutta)
Oldest hill station	Mussoorie (declared 1825)

For deeper context on historical events, see the History book. For science and technology details, see the Science & Technology book.